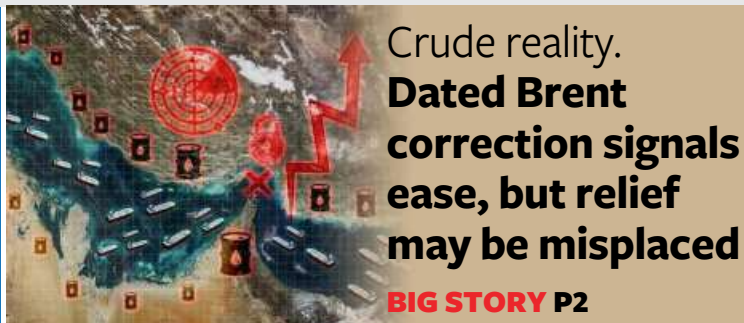


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India Inc's Q4 weathers geopolitical storm

AT CROSSROADS. However, challenges will remain if resolution to West Asia war is delayed and starts impacting global and domestic economies**Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli**
bl. research bureau

While India Inc had to contend with the impact of the West Asia conflict for nearly one-third of Q4FY26 (the month of March), higher volumes helped offset cost pressures.

For the quarter, India Inc delivered healthy revenue and adjusted PAT growth (PAT adjusted for extraordinary items) of 14 per cent and 18 per cent year-on-year, respectively. Excluding the 41 BFSI companies from the 647 firms that had reported results till May 7, 2026, revenue and adjusted PAT growth stood at 17 per cent and 18 per cent y-o-y, respectively.

Ex-BFSI, gross margins declined by 68 bps y-o-y to 57.2 per cent, but EBITDA margins remained flat. This implies two things. One, the gross margin decline indicating supply chain challenges from the ongoing US-Iran conflict have manifested sharply in the quarter. Two, companies benefitted from volume growth as fixed overheads were spread over larger volumes, as indicated by flattish EBITDA margins despite lower gross

margins. While the earnings print is strong, the 7 per cent correction in the Nifty 50 year-to-date may be justified given the uncertainties ahead. Without a quick resolution to the West Asia war, cost pressures can amplify in FY27. Oil marketing companies (OMCs) are yet to pass on the impact of higher crude oil prices on retail fuel. If done, this may have a bearing on consumption.

Further it is also important to note that major OMCs are yet to report results. During periods like this, their results can have a reasonable adverse impact on the overall trend.

India Inc's balance-sheet strength, however, remains resilient, with the interest coverage ratio improving to 7.5 times in Q4FY26 from 7.1 times in Q4FY25.

Among sectors, capital goods and pharmaceuticals posted strong EBITDA margin expansion of 163 bps y-o-y and 210 bps y-o-y, respectively, while power generation and cement saw margin contraction of 160-170 bps y-o-y.

BETTER-OFF SECTORS

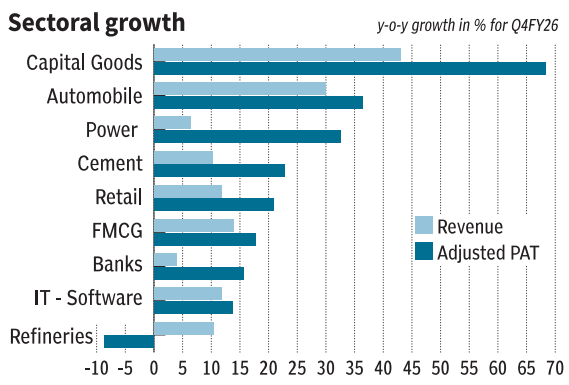
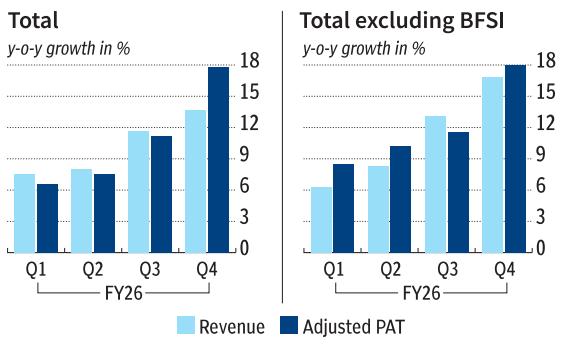
While most sectors have delivered strong growth in the quarter, capital goods, auto-

mobiles and power generation are more likely to sustain the momentum. FMCG and banks are likely to face a mixed outlook, while IT, refineries and cement may face challenges.

Capital goods delivered the best growth in Q4 with revenue and adjusted PAT growth at 43 and 68 per cent, respectively. Among sector leaders, BHEL reported a strong revenue growth of 37 per cent y-o-y aided by EBITDA margin expansion of 500 bps, the company reported a 155 per cent y-o-y growth in adjusted PAT. The sector can deliver good growth aided by multiple tailwinds, including the power infrastructure upcycle, railway electrification, private capex recovery, data centre investments and defence spending.

Automobiles segment enjoyed strong volume growth across categories, including exports, along with price hikes. Industry leader Maruti Suzuki reported 11 per cent y-o-y growth in both volumes and pricing, translating into 24 per cent y-o-y revenue growth, though EBITDA margins remained flat at 11.7 per cent. Operating leverage gains were partly offset by commodity inflation, particularly in copper, aluminium and other indus-

How India Inc fared



Source: Capitaline

trial inputs which saw sharp spurt in prices during the quarter.

For banks, the credit growth now is being led by corporate and commercial seg-

ments, with retail and housing witnessing slower growth.

MIXED OUTLOOK

Bellwether HDFC reported commercial segment credit

growth at 17 per cent y-o-y compared to 6 per cent y-o-y growth in retail. Net interest margin compression is expected to be stable as HDFC and ICICI reported -2 bps and +6 bps improvement in NIMs in the quarter. Asset quality remains healthy, but risks may emerge as an extended war can hurt SME prospects.

FMCG volume growth continues to recover despite sharper price increases at the consumer end. Industry leader Hindustan Unilever reported volume growth of 6 per cent y-o-y in Q4FY26 (2 per cent in Q4FY25) and an implied price growth of 2 per cent y-o-y in the quarter. But the gross margins declined by 120 bps in the quarter to 50.7 per cent as input costs have risen by 8-10 per cent y-o-y due to supply chain issues. This is expected to impact margins further.

WEAK SECTORS

In the oil and gas sector, OMCs are expected to reflect significant margin pressure. Standalone refiners, however, remain relatively well placed due to elevated gross refining margins (GRMs). Compared to historical GRMs of \$6-7 per barrel in Q3, companies repor-

ted \$13-14 per barrel in Q4. Although GRMs are expected to moderate, they are still likely to remain above pre-conflict assumptions through FY27-28. That said, windfall taxes on refining exports and higher procurement, insurance and logistics costs could erode part of the gains.

Cement prices are improving along with volumes as capacity expansion is reflected in growth for Ultratech, Ambuja and Shree Cement. The three leading companies reported 8-10 per cent y-o-y volume growth and 1-2 per cent y-o-y pricing growth. But sharp raw material cost increase — including a 7 per cent y-o-y rise in UltraTech's raw material cost per tonne and 26 per cent increase for Shree Cement — weighed on profitability. Sector EBITDA margins declined 170 bps y-o-y during the period. As a result, even with stronger volumes, profit growth is likely to remain modest going forward.

Despite India Inc's robust quarterly performance, supply chain disruptions are likely to remain the primary investor overhang. Concerns are further amplified by the risk of softer demand if the conflict persists.

INVESTMENT. FOCUS

SAMHI Hotels: Accumulate

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

After a steep correction from its highs, SAMHI Hotels now looks like a more investible story than it did at IPO.

Despite West Asia-related disruptions, India's hotel sector remains structurally favourable, with demand from business travel, MICE and premium leisure outpacing new supply.

SAMHI has moved from losses to sustained profitability, reduced debt and lowered interest costs. Operating momentum is decent, with healthy revenue growth and margins. The company is also premiumising its portfolio and expanding through capital-light strategic moves. Key risks include debt, project execution, assumptions around new platforms and sector cyclicality. But valuation is now more reasonable at about 14.6 times FY27 earnings and 9.3 times EV/EBITDA, making dips attractive for investors with a 3-5 year time horizon.

Centre tightens labour compliance rules for govt contractors

Our Bureau
New Delhi

In a push to strengthen protection for outsourced and contractual workers, the Centre has introduced a new procurement-linked compliance framework making timely payment of wages and statutory social security contributions mandatory for firms seeking government contracts.

The reforms, issued through fresh instructions by the Department of Expenditure, will apply across central ministries, departments, autonomous bodies and central public sector enterprises (CPSEs).

The Ministry of Labour and Employment said the move aims to address persistent complaints of delayed wages, non-payment of provident fund and other statutory dues, and weak accountability among contractors engaged by government entities.

According to the Ministry,



TIGHTENING THE SCREWS. Firms may face a 3-year ban from government procurement not only for corruption or integrity violations, but also for failing to pay wages/deposit statutory social security dues

the new framework operationalises worker safeguards under the four Labour Codes while significantly tightening enforcement through financial penalties, debarment and blacklisting provisions for defaulting firms.

Under directions issued by the Procurement Policy Division on May 8, ministries and government bodies have been instructed to strictly monitor wage payments by contractors. Drawing and disbursing

officers (DDOs) will now be required to verify compliance every month. The government has reiterated that under Section 55(3) of the Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions Code, 2020, the principal employer is responsible for ensuring timely wage payments by contractors.

The directions also invoke provisions of the Code on Wages, 2019, prescribing strict timelines for salary dis-

bursal. Daily wage workers must be paid by the end of the shift, weekly wage earners before the weekly holiday, fortnightly workers within two days of the end of the fortnight, and monthly wage employees within seven days of the succeeding month, the Ministry said.

WAGE TRANSPARENCY

To improve transparency, all wage payments must be made through bank transfer or electronic mode. Contractors will also be required to electronically notify the principal employers after disbursing salaries.

Government departments have been directed to incorporate penalty clauses in contracts for delayed wage payments and ensure adequate fund availability before awarding manpower contracts. Ministries using the Government e-Marketplace (GeM) or similar procurement platforms will also have to earmark funds specifically for outsourced manpower

payments. The Centre has also tightened reimbursement timelines. Contractors must submit bills by the 10th of every month after wage disbursement, while DDOs have been instructed to clear payments by the 15th.

Principal employers have now been empowered to directly pay contract workers in cases of prolonged delay by contractors, with repeat violations attracting blacklisting and wider debarment action.

Simultaneously, the government has amended Rule 151 of the General Financial Rules (GFR), 2017, substantially expanding the grounds for debarment from government bidding. Firms can now face exclusion from government procurement for up to three years not only for corruption or integrity violations, but also for failure to pay wages or deposit statutory social security contributions, especially in cases where the government has had to step in and make payments on behalf of defaulting contractors.

BENGAL BREAKS NEW GROUND



MOMENT OF CHANGE. Prime Minister Narendra Modi (centre) with West Bengal Governor RN Ravi (left) and BJP leader Suwendu Adhikari during Adhikari's swearing-in ceremony as Chief Minister at Brigade Parade Ground in Kolkata on Saturday. Ravi administered the oath of office and secrecy to the 55-year-old BJP leader after the party's landmark Assembly election victory ended 15 years of TMC rule in the State. In the recently-concluded Assembly elections, the BJP secured 207 seats, while the Trinamool Congress won 80 seats ANI

FPIs' stake in Indian equities falls to 14-year low

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

Foreign portfolio investors' (FPIs) share in Indian equities has fallen to a nearly 14-year low, even as domestic institutions have quietly emerged as the market's largest stakeholder — a structural shift unfolding alongside another week of sustained foreign selling.

Per NSDL data, FPIs were net sellers in Indian equities in four of the five trading sessions during the week ended May 8.

On Monday (May 4), they pulled out ₹8,035.69 crore through stock exchanges. Tuesday offered brief respite, with FPIs turning net buyers worth ₹2,969.02 crore. Selling resumed on Wednesday with outflows of

₹3,399.03 crore, followed by the sell-off on Thursday at ₹5,697.61 crore.

By Friday (May 8), selling had nearly tapered off, with net outflows narrowing sharply to ₹69.31 crore, as gross purchases of ₹18,514.38 crore almost matched gross sales of ₹18,583.69 crore.

On an aggregate basis — combining stock exchange and primary market flows — FPI equity outflows for the week stood at ₹14,207.20 crore.

DIIs OVERTAKE FPIs

In contrast, domestic institutional investors (DIIs) now hold 18.9 per cent of Indian equities, overtaking FPIs for the first time since December 2024 and steadily widening the gap.

Details p12

Joseph Vijay to take oath as TN Chief Minister today

Our Bureau
Chennai

The political uncertainty prevailing in Tamil Nadu since the day of the Assembly poll results finally ended on Saturday with C Joseph Vijay all set to take oath as the Chief Minister at 10 am on Sunday at Nehru Stadium, Chennai.

In his fourth visit in four days, Vijay, this time with leaders of supporting parties — the Communists, Congress, VCK, and IUML — met Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar on Saturday to stake claim to form the government.

In a statement, the Governor's Office said that the Governor has appointed C Joseph Vijay as the CM of Tamil Nadu and invited him to form the Ministry.

VOTE OF CONFIDENCE

He also directed the CM-designate to seek vote of confidence of



IMPASSE ENDS. Tamil Nadu Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar hands over the letter of appointment to TVK chief C Joseph Vijay as the new Chief Minister, at the Lok Bhavan, in Chennai, on Saturday PTI

the Assembly on or before May 13.
Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam

(TVK) crossed the majority mark with the support of 121 MLAs. The breakthrough came after un-

Seat tally

Party	Seats
TVK	108*
INC	5
CPI	2
CPI(M)	2
VCK	2
IUML	2
Total	121

* Includes two seats won by C Joseph Vijay (in Perambur and Tiruchirappalli East)

conditional support from the Viduthala Chiruthaigal Katchi (VCK) and the Indian Union Muslim League (IUML).

The dramatic developments unfolded through Saturday as the deadline to form the next government was set to expire on Sunday night, following a fractured verdict in the Assembly elections.

The new coalition government

brings to an end the decades-old rule of the State alternatively by the two Dravidian parties — the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) and the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK).

Offering unconditional support from outside, VCK leader Thol Thirumavalavan told presspersons on Saturday that the party wanted to do its bit to avoid the imposition of President's rule in the State.

OTHER LEADERS WISH

Stalin, in a post on X, said his government had developed Tamil Nadu in all sectors during the past five years and expressed hope that the incoming administration would continue the welfare and development schemes introduced by his government.

AIADMK leader Edappadi K Palaniswami also congratulated the new party set to form the government, without naming any single party.

b1.portfolio

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

The legendary energy trader John Arnold recently posted on X: *The fair market value of oil ticks up every day that goes by without an articulated plan for how to end the war*

It's over 70 days since the US-Iran-Israel war started and the Strait of Hormuz has been made unnavigable. In this period, oil prices have gyrated wildly — up 39 per cent since day zero of the war, yet also down 15 per cent from the March 9 peak.

As the tug of war plays out in the commodities exchange, at stake are the global real economy and stock markets. After all, for the demand-supply mismatch to get sorted out without any major economic impact, the strait must open immediately to ease supply shock (doesn't look to be the case currently) or prices must go so high that demand gets destroyed. As things stand today, cumulatively supply of 900 million barrels (mb) of oil has been lost and the counting is still on.

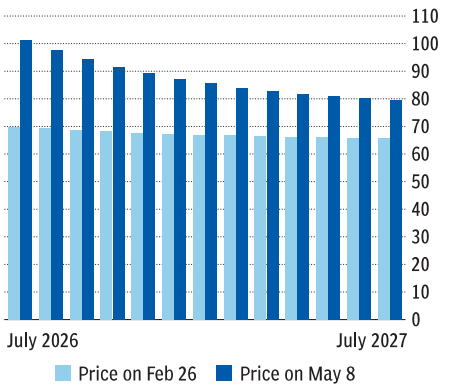
So, are crude prices headed up or down?

THE PRICE SHOCK

Prior to the war, crude oil prices were expected to trade much lower than the current levels. According to a US Energy Information Administration (EIA) release in February, despite supply disruptions amounting to 3 mb/d (million barrels per day), then the highest since September 2024 — due to outages in the US and Kazakhstan, Brent crude oil spot prices were expected to average \$58 per barrel in 2026, nearly 16 per cent lower than the 2025 average price of \$69 per barrel.

EIA had anticipated global oil production to exceed demand, resulting in inventory builds and eventually weighing on prices. In its February Short-Term Energy Outlook (STEO), global oil production and consumption for 2026 were projected at 107.85 mb/d and 104.79 mb/d respectively, implying a surplus of 3.06 mb/d. In comparison, excess supply in 2025 was estimated at 2.7 mb/d. But the war flipped the equation.

Futures curves stay in backwardation

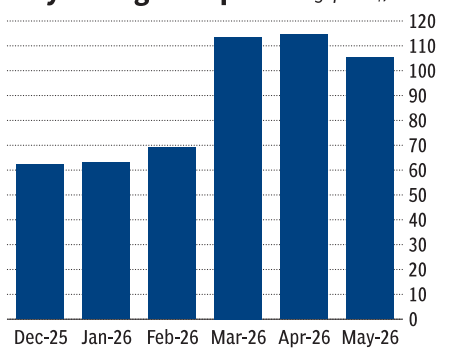


The tables turned on February 28, when the US and Israel attacked Iran and subsequently, the Strait of Hormuz was closed on March 4, impacting the flow of 20 mb/d of crude oil, accounting for nearly 20 per cent of global supply.

Brent crude futures surged to a high of \$119.50 on March 9. Since then, prices have remained volatile, and the contract closed at \$101.29 on May 8. Dated Brent (the benchmark for physical crude oil cargoes) marked a high of \$144.46 on April 7.

The price of Indian basket of crude oil hit a 14-year high of \$114.48 (per barrel) in April before moderating to \$105.40 in May.

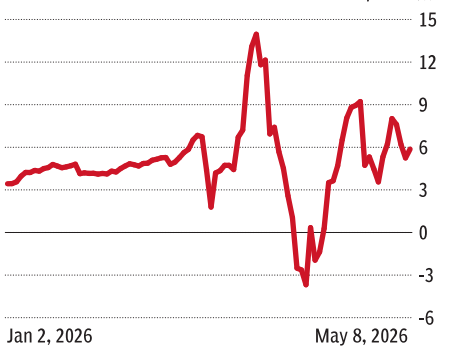
Indian crude basket hits 14-year high in April



Source: PPAC

While crude oil prices surged in both the futures and physical markets, the latter saw a far sharper reaction. Dated Brent's premium over Brent futures widened to an unprecedented \$35.87 on April 9, as demand for immediately-deliverable cargoes shot up. Even during the onset of the Russia-Ukraine war, Dated Brent had peaked at \$137.67 on March 8, 2022, and its premium rose only to \$18.42 on March 9, 2022.

Brent-WTI spread widens sharply amid Hormuz crisis



The 900-million barrel question

CRUDE REALITY. Dated Brent's 27 per cent correction from peak signals ease, but upward pressure on crude prices remains embedded in the market structure. So, are crude prices headed up or down?

The Brent-WTI futures spread widened sharply, as Brent, the global seaborne benchmark, reacted more aggressively to Hormuz-related supply risks, while record US production capped WTI's upside. The spread later slipped into negative territory as panic eased with SPR releases, rerouting and arrival of previously-booked cargoes, while tighter US inventories and strong exports supported WTI.

The scramble for near-term supplies also pushed Brent futures into steep backwardation, reflecting market's willingness to pay more for immediate supplies. On February 26, just two days before the US struck Iran, the spread between the first-month and twelfth-month Brent contracts (M1-M12) stood at \$3.95. It expanded sharply to \$31.57 on May 4.

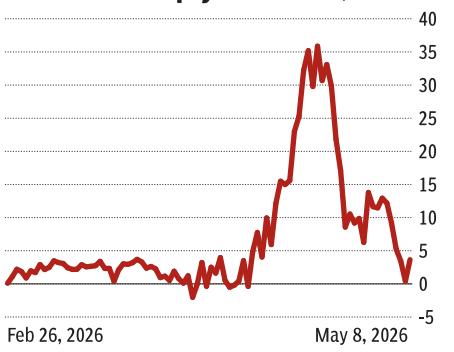
But prices, particularly of Dated Brent, by closing at \$104.94 on Friday, has dropped 27 per cent from its peak of \$144.46 over the last month.

PANIC EASES, PREMIUM ERODES

Dated Brent, is now closely trading with the futures contract, which is now at \$101.29. The premium has now significantly narrowed to \$3.65 compared to its highest level of \$35.87 on April 9, indicating that panic in the physical market is easing. Consequently, the M1-M12 spread has now moderated to \$21.06.

This could be because buyers are no longer bidding aggressively for cargoes. The current market sentiment points to temporary breathing room as cargoes are now reaching destinations, SPR (Strategic Petroleum Reserves) releases are easing immediate scarcity, and buyers might have largely moved to the sidelines. This appears more like a wait-and-watch phase rather than genuine confidence in resolution.

Physical crude premium narrows sharply



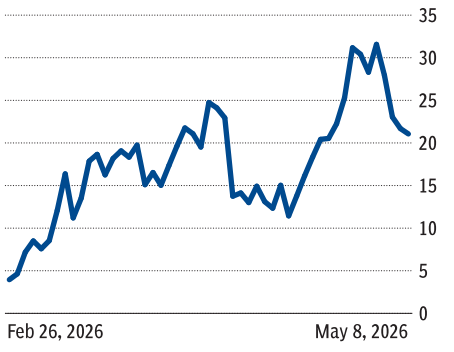
So the important thing to note here is that the cooling in price will require hope to be transformed into reality, in the absence of which it may again start to move up.

Moreover, the steep backwardation in futures, the M1-M12 spread is still at elevated level of \$21.06 despite the Dated Brent correction. This tells that the physical market shows panic easing, but the futures curve still prices in near-term scarcity. If Hormuz doesn't show signs of reopening within weeks, refiners will likely be forced back into aggressive bidding, potentially reigniting physical tightness.

Note that even if the Strait reopens right now, operational constraints, maintenance backlogs

and tanker logistics could extend full supply restoration to weeks or months. Especially after the production shut-ins (now at 7.5 mb/d as per EIA STEO) from Hormuz-dependent producers.

Backwardation eases but remains elevated



SUPPLY ARITHMETIC

According to the International Energy Agency (IEA), the cumulative supply loss in March and April was 800 mb. IEA places the overall loss in oil exports exceeding 13 mb/d after rerouting 3.2 mb/d to bypass Hormuz. Rerouting has been through Saudi Arabia's East-West Petroline and the UAE's Abu Dhabi Crude Oil Pipeline (ADCOP).

Considering 13 mb/d loss in supply, the market has forgone approximately 104 mb in May so far, taking the total supply gap to a staggering 904 mb since the beginning of March, which is around 14,300 crore litres of oil. This is the equivalent of around 60 per cent of crude oil that India consumes annually!

Though partial offsets have emerged as follows — the IEA had announced a coordinated release of 400 mb from strategic reserves on March 11 (US will be the largest contributor as EIA committed 172 mb); demand destruction of 1.5 mb/d in Q2, which is 135 mb for this period; incremental US exports averaging 0.45 mb/d since the beginning of the conflict in comparison to the first two months of this year.

More recently, the US has been acting as an important buffer in terms of both production

Oil market deficit and offsets

Volume (million barrels)			
Supply loss (Mar 1 - May 8)*	EIA Q2 inventory draw forecast (Q2, 90 days @ 5.1 mb/d)		
-904	-459		
IEA strategic reserve release (time line of release unknown)	Demand destruction (Q2, 90 days @ 1.5 mb/d)		
400	135		
Chinese drop in imports (3.2 mb/d in April)	Incremental US export (Feb 28 - May 1) (62 days @ 0.45 mb/d)		
96	28		

*cumulative figure; still rising as Hormuz remains shut; mb/d: million barrels/day
Note: Above figures correspond to different time periods
Source: EIA, IEA, Bloomberg

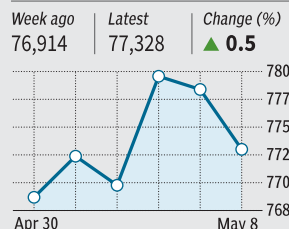
WISE WORDS.

“The rub has been that government has been exceptionally able in printing money and creating promises, but is unable to print gold or create oil

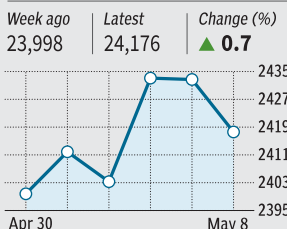
WARREN BUFFETT

MARKET ACTION.

SENSEX



NIFTY



the IEA's April Oil Market Report (OMR) shows inventory draw outside of the Middle East Gulf at 6.6 mb/d (205 mb) in March as refiners scrambled for accessible cargoes, while crude inventories continued piling up in the Gulf, effectively trapped behind a closed Strait.

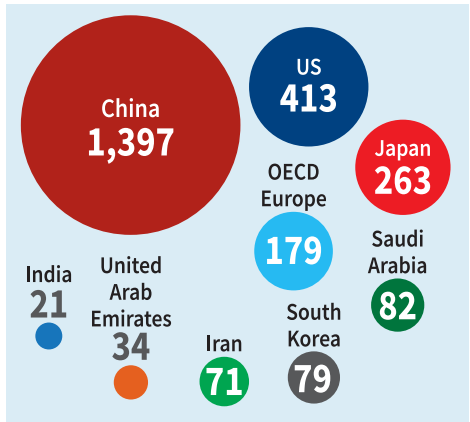
Comparing 400 mb release and considering EIA's comparatively lower pace of inventory draw of 459 mb (5.1 mb/d for three months as mentioned above) in Q2, the release cannot even fully cover the draws in 90-day period.

IEA also notes that crude oil inventories in importing Asian countries declined by 31 mb in March, with further draws expected in April. Where inventories failed to bridge the supply gap, demand itself has taken a hit. Most notably, Asian petrochemical producers have curtailed operating rates.

China, the world's largest crude oil importer, has reduced imports from 11.7 mb/d before the war to 8.2 mb/d in April, implying a demand reduction of 3.5 mb/d, according to a Bloomberg report. The sharp reduction in imports is emerging as one of the biggest balancing forces in the market, potentially taking some pressure off the global draining reserves.

Oil stockpile buffers across economies

Oil stockpiles (million barrels) (as of Dec 2025)



Note: China's figure includes total inventories held by national oil companies, whereas figures for other countries represent only strategic petroleum reserves (SPR) Source: EIA

While the IEA members hold inventory stockpiles of 1,800 mb (1,200 mb are emergency stockpiles and further 600 mb of industry stocks held under government obligation), how much of them is accessible is uncertain. Assuming full access to 1,800 mb at an inventory draw of 5.1 mb/d, we have 353 days of stocks left. But draining to the tee is never an option. Besides, large minimum balances need to be maintained in storage facilities to keep the system running.

As per a JP Morgan report, the global inventory is 860 mb. Out of this, 280 mb have been drawn down, leaving 580 mb of usable inventory. According to them, the global oil inventories are declining at a rate of 8 mb/d. In this case, we're running dangerously close to the bottom with only about 73 days of stocks left.

THE DEMAND QUESTION

If elevated oil prices sustain for a prolonged period, it could trigger demand destruction and weigh on prices. In its April OMR, the IEA forecasts oil demand growth to contract 80 kb/d (0.08 mb/d) in 2026 compared to previous estimate of a growth of 730 kb/d (0.73 mb/d), cutting 810 kb/d (0.81 mb/d) of demand for the year. It also forecasts a 1.5 mb/d decline in Q2CY26 demand, the sharpest quarterly drop since the Covid-19 pandemic.

The IEA, on the other hand, has reduced its 2026 demand growth estimate from 1.2 mb/d to 0.6 mb/d. Taking both projections into account, the loss in demand could be in the 0.6-0.81 mb/d range. Assuming an average demand loss of around 0.705 mb/d between April and December this year, the implied reduction works out to nearly 190 mb for the period, partially offsetting the supply shortfall.

That said, there are two competing arguments from the demand perspective. One is that elevated prices will eventually destroy demand, leading to lower prices and reducing the impact of supply disruptions over time. The other is that inventories currently being depleted will eventually need to be replenished, potentially keeping demand elevated and crude prices firm even if Hormuz reopens.

IS THE UPSIDE OVER?

Not necessarily. While the 27 per cent correction in Dated Brent from its April peak and its premium over futures dropping to \$3.65 suggests immediate panic is easing, upward pressure on crude prices remains embedded in the market structure.

At a net loss of 13 mb/d, the supply crisis, which has now reached a cumulative loss of approximately 900 mb, will deepen for each additional day that Hormuz remains closed. Production shut-ins cannot reverse instantly even if the Strait reopens, as operational normalisation will take weeks and global inventory depletion means buffer capacity is thinning, supporting the upside risks. EIA, in April STEO, has made upward revision in Brent crude oil spot price to an average \$96 in 2026 compared to \$58 in February STEO. Note that April STEO was released on April 7 and since then the upward risks to price has only gone up. One should closely watch their May STEO, scheduled to be released on May 12 for updated projections factoring in the recent developments.

One should also note that the IMF has warned that oil at \$125 could push countries outside the US and China into recession.

Based on technical analysis, crude oil prices can hit \$140. For details, check p6

Riding market volatility with agility

FUND CALL. Edelweiss Aggressive Hybrid Fund combines factors such as growth, quality and momentum to identify stocks

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl, research bureau

Edelweiss Aggressive Hybrid Fund has established itself as one of the consistent performers in the aggressive hybrid fund category. Since becoming eligible for *bl.portfolio*'s Star Track ratings, the scheme has maintained either a four-star or five-star rating across the last three editions.

Currently, it holds a four-star rating under our framework. Over the past seven years, it has delivered a compounded annual growth rate (CAGR) of 14.4 per cent, comfortably ahead of the category average of 12.5 per cent.

A distinguishing feature of the fund is its factor-driven investment framework. Key portfolio characteristics include maintaining equity exposure largely in the 70-75 per cent range and following a short-duration strategy on the debt side.

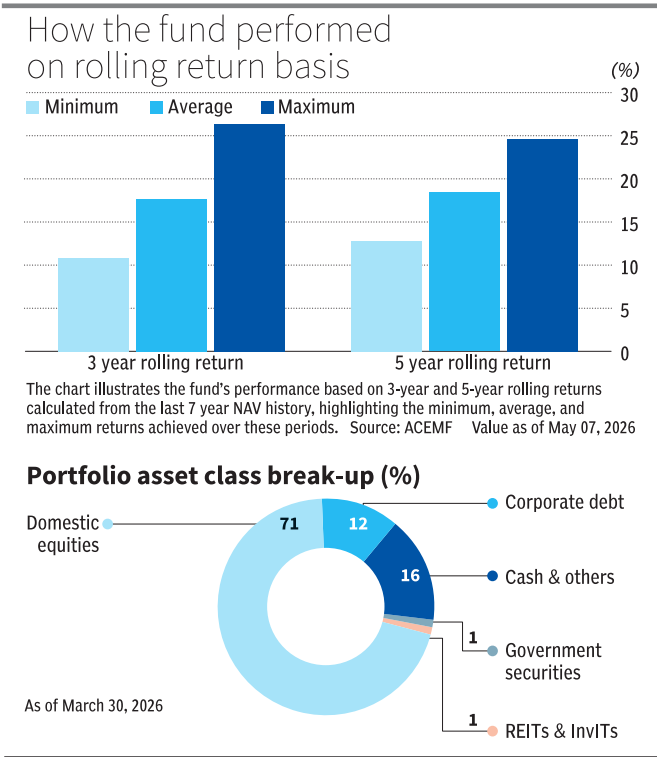
Aggressive hybrid funds category is designed to provide a balance between growth and stability. They typically allocate 65-80 per cent of their portfolio to equities and 20-35 per cent to debt instruments.

This mix makes them an attractive option for investors seeking reasonable growth while keeping overall risk at a moderate level.

EQUITY STRATEGY

The fund's equity portfolio is managed through a quantitative, factor-based framework rather than the conventional discretionary stock-picking approach followed by most peers in the category.

Using quantitative models, the strategy combines multiple investment factors such as growth, quality and momentum to identify stocks across market-capitalisation segments. Within the aggressive hybrid fund space, only a limited number of schemes, including Quant Aggressive Hybrid Fund, follow a comparable factor-oriented investment approach.



The investment universe broadly consists of the top 500 companies by market capitalisation. This universe is then divided into four separate buckets: The top 50 large-cap companies, the next 50 companies, mid-cap stocks and small-cap stocks.

Within each of these segments, the fund managers identify companies that qualify under growth-at-reasonable-price and quality-at-reasonable-price parameters.

For growth-oriented investing, the fund analyses both growth and valuation metrics to determine whether a company offers sustainable earnings expansion at attractive valuations. For quality investing, the evaluation focuses on parameters such as return ratios, debt-to-equity levels and consistency in earnings performance. The valuation comfort of these businesses is also assessed before inclusion in the portfolio.

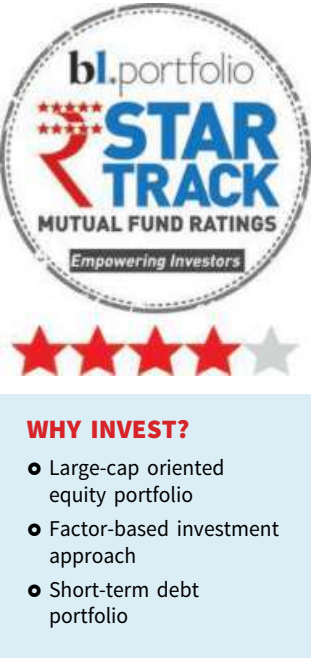
Momentum is another important pillar of the strategy.

The fund combines growth, quality and momentum factors across all four market-cap buckets to build the final portfolio. Overall, the portfolio is designed to remain broadly equally weighted across the three styles.

The fund also follows a disciplined rebalancing framework. Portfolio reviews and rebalancing exercises are conducted eight times a year.

Typically, one review takes place before quarterly results and another after the results season. Before results, the fund managers assess market positioning and expectations regarding future growth trends. After results, the portfolio is reassessed based on actual earnings data, growth delivery and changes in company fundamentals.

The fund follows a flexi-cap approach and as per the latest portfolio as of March 31, 2026, the large-, mid- and small-cap allocation stood at 47 per cent, 15 per cent and 8 per cent respectively.



Currently, the fund is overweight on sectors such as pharma and healthcare, capital goods and, to some extent, chemicals, where it sees better opportunities.

On the other hand, the fund remains underweight on oil and gas, IT and financial services. The top three sectors in the latest portfolio were banks (16 per cent), pharma (7 per cent) and telecom (5 per cent).

Over the last one year, the fund increased allocation to telecom, petroleum products and capital markets by 2-3 percentage points, while trimming exposure to IT, industrial manufacturing and pharma sectors.

DEBT STRATEGY

The debt allocation is managed conservatively in line with short-duration fund principles, with the portfolio focusing on high-quality corporate bonds and avoiding aggressive duration calls.

Over the last five years, the fund has maintained a Macaulay duration between 0.7 and 3.5 years, ensuring limited sensitivity to interest rate movements.

The strategy restricts invest-

ments largely to AAA-rated securities. This helps to reduce the risk of sharp mark-to-market losses arising from rating downgrades or deteriorating issuer fundamentals.

Prominent names in its debt portfolio include Aditya Birla Finance, HDB Financial Services, NABARD and Bharti Telecom.

As of March 2026, the fund's debt portfolio reported a yield to maturity of 6.7 per cent, lower than the category average of 7.5 per cent due to its short-duration investment mandate.

As per the latest portfolio as of March 2026, it held 12 per cent in corporate debt and less than 1 per cent in government securities.

PERFORMANCE

Five-year rolling returns over the past seven years show that the fund delivered an average annual return of 18.4 per cent, outperforming the category average of 16 per cent.

The five-year return range has varied between 12.8 per cent and 24.6 per cent.

The fund also demonstrated decent performance in three-year rolling returns, delivering a 17.7 per cent CAGR compared with the category average of 15.4 per cent.

From a cost perspective, the regular plan has an expense ratio of 1.86 per cent, lower-than-the-category average of 2 per cent.

Interestingly, the direct plan's expense ratio stands at 0.37 per cent (lowest among peers) vs category average of 0.86 per cent. As of March 2026, the fund managed assets worth ₹3,309 crore.

This provides equity taxation benefits, given its allocation of more than 65 per cent to equities. Investors with a medium-risk profile who are concerned about the current market volatility can consider this fund. An investment horizon of five years or more is ideal.

SIPs are the preferred route, considering the prevailing volatile market conditions.

ALERTS.

Motilal Oswal Contra Fund launched

Motilal Oswal Mutual Fund has announced the launch of its new fund offer (NFO), "Motilal Oswal Contra Fund", an open-ended equity scheme following a contrarian investment strategy. A contrarian strategy is an investing style which typically invests against prevailing market trends. The NFO period ends May 22. The scheme will be benchmarked against Nifty 500 Total Return Index. If redeemed within 365 days from the day of allotment, there is an exit load of 1 per cent. Its fund managers are Ankit Agarwal, Varun Sharma, Bhalchandra Shinde, Rakesh Shetty and Swapnil Mayekar.

Invesco MF resumes international scheme subscriptions

Invesco Mutual Fund has informed that it has decided to revoke temporary suspension of subscription in Designated Schemes, issued vide notice dated January 2, 2026, and resume subscription through lumpsum purchases, switch-ins and fresh registration for SIP, STP and IDCW Transfer Plan in the following schemes of the fund effective May 8 - Invesco India - Invesco Global Equity Income Fund of Fund; Invesco India - Invesco Pan European Equity Fund of Fund; and Invesco India - Invesco Global Consumer Trends Fund of Fund. The subscriptions will be allowed only up to the headroom available without breaching the overseas investments limits as of February 1, 2022, at the Fund level.

Best NPS plans

Top pension funds in each category based on 5-year CAGR						
Name of the fund	NAV (₹) as on May 8	Returns (% CAGR)			Assets (₹ cr)	
		3-year	5-year	10-year		
TIER I: EQUITY PLANS						
HDFC Pension Fund	53.9	13.6	13.0	14.2	69,293	
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	74.0	15.0	14.0	14.0	25,125	
Kotak Pension Fund	67.2	14.2	13.7	13.8	4,151	
TIER I: GOVERNMENT BOND PLANS						
LIC Pension Fund	30.7	6.4	5.9	8.3	8,421	
SBI Pension Fund	41.2	6.5	5.9	7.8	27,519	
HDFC Pension Fund	28.1	6.1	5.6	7.7	50,159	
TIER I: CORPORATE DEBT PLANS						
HDFC Pension Fund	30.1	7.7	6.8	8.2	33,108	
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	45.4	7.5	6.5	8.0	13,143	
SBI Pension Fund	45.6	7.5	6.5	8.0	14,868	
TIER II: EQUITY PLANS						
HDFC Pension Fund	46.6	13.6	13.0	14.2	1,673	
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	58.4	14.8	13.9	14.0	700	
Kotak Pension Fund	59.0	14.2	13.6	13.7	202	

*Source: Value Research. Returns as on May 8, 2026

MULTI COMMODITY EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED

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₹2429 Cr
TOTAL INCOME
▲ 101% YoY

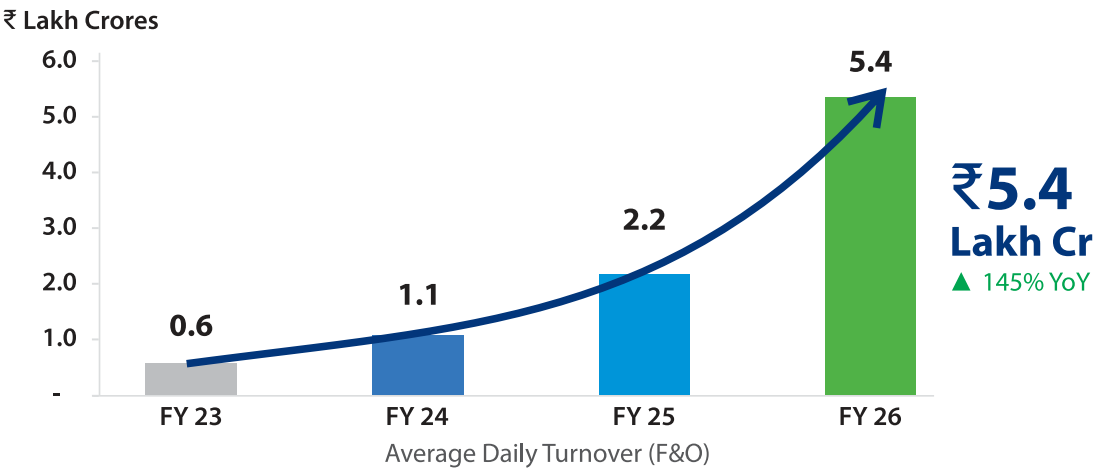


₹1774 Cr
EBITDA | 73% MARGIN
▲ 133% YoY



₹1332 Cr
PROFIT AFTER TAX
▲ 138% YoY

ADT GROWTH TRAJECTORY - FY26 ACCELERATION



FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE (Q4 FY26)

(₹ Crores)	Q4 FY26	Q4 FY25	YoY
Revenue from Operations	889	291	▲ 205%
EBITDA	703	189	▲ 271%
EBITADA Margin	76%	59%	
Profit After Tax	530	135	▲ 291%
PAT Margin	57%	42%	

BUSINESS HIGHLIGHTS (FY26)



Key Rankings (FIA for 2025)

- MCX is world's largest Commodity Options Exchange
- MCX is world's 4th largest Commodity Exchange



Growth Drivers

- Two strong pillars of Bullion and Energy with good metals growth
- +496% in Bullion
 - +116% in Base Metals
 - +29% in Energy



Balanced Growth of Futures & Options

- Futures revenue : ₹693 Cr (136%)
- Options revenue : ₹1,398 Cr (109%)



New Product Expansion

- Gold Ten Futures
- Electricity Futures
- BULLEX Options
- Cardamom Futures
- Nickel Futures
- Gold & Silver Monthly Options



Participation Growth

- Increase in traded clients - 20.9 lakh, increased from 13 lakh in FY25
- Healthy growth of new members, financial and corporate institutions



Robust Delivery Driven Contracts

- Gold: 21 MT
- Silver: 401MT
- Base Metals: 95,781 MT

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For Multi Commodity Exchange of India Limited

sd/-
Ms. Praveena Rai
Managing Director & CEO
DIN:09474203

Place: Mumbai | Date: May 08, 2026

P/E multiples can be the same number yet poles apart

INVEST WISE. Rising cost of equity amid tough macros and geopolitics suggests markets may be complacent to risks



Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl. research bureau

A couple months ago, the macros that underpin equities looked completely different — inflation was controlled, interest rates were lowered and discretionary consumption was recovering well post GST cuts. There didn't seem to be any serious threat to earnings growth. However, since March, the picture has turned gloomy —oil price remains volatile and elevated, monsoon could be below normal and higher fertiliser costs could stoke food inflation. These now cast uncertainty on steady delivery of earnings growth by Indian companies. Meanwhile, geopolitics is the most complex it has been in decades, adding another layer of uncertainty.

Since the war broke out, markets have corrected to reflect this uncertainty but at the same time, fuelling talk that this is a good time to buy, with valuations now below long-term averages. Nifty 50's P/E dipped close to 20x in March against a 10-year mean of about 25x. Today, it trades at about 22x (niftyindices.com), having recovered from the bottom in early April. But is every 22x Nifty P/E really the same? That question matters more once you factor in the quietly rising cost of equity (CoE), which is often overlooked.

CoE or the expected rate of return from equities is the discount rate used to convert estimated future cash flows to their present value and is a key variable in valuation. Mathematically, for a given set of cash flows, a higher expected rate of return means a lower valuation, and vice-versa. Logically too, this holds. Higher-risk assets demand higher returns, and investors try to achieve this by paying a lower entry price. Thus, in theory, there is an inverse relationship between CoE and net present value.

With that introduction to CoE out of the way, let us circle back to the question. Today, Nifty trades at 22x earnings, just as it did at the beginning of CY04. However, the CoE then was just 9.9 per cent as against today's 11.7 per cent

(from 10.8 per cent as of January 1, 2026). The index's EPS grew 50 per cent in CY04 over CY03 and it posted returns of 11 per cent. With such high earnings growth highly unlikely in the said macro backdrop, this increase in CoE further signals a possibility of equities underperforming expectations in CY26.

In this story, we analyse 25 years of data to observe whether the theoretical inverse relationship between valuation and CoE has held. But before getting into the analysis, it helps to understand how CoE is computed — and who better to learn from than Professor Aswath Damodaran — the 'Dean of Valuation' himself.

THE FRAMEWORK
Professor Damodaran's CoE is broadly based on the CAPM (capital asset pricing model) equation: $CoE = R_f + \beta * (R_m - R_f)$ where, R_f – risk-free rate of return, R_m – expected return of the broad stock market and β – beta, a measure of relative risk of a portfolio versus the broad market portfolio (like S&P 500, for instance). The term $R_m - R_f$ is also called equity risk premium (ERP).

Assume R_f , R_m and β at 5 per cent, 10 per cent and 1.2. CoE in this case would work out to 11 per cent ($5 + 1.2 * (10 - 5)$).

Damodaran's approach to each of these variables is different from the traditional way of computing them and is logically sounder and here is how it is done.

RISK-FREE RATE
Textbooks suggest using the yield on a long-term government bond in the same currency as the cash flows being discounted. For rupee cash flows, this would be the yield on the 10-year government security.

Damodaran points out a flaw here. Even sovereigns carry default risk, however remote. Hence, he suggests adjusting the sovereign yield for default risk using its credit default swap (CDS) spread. A CDS works like insurance — you pay a premium to be indemnified if the sovereign defaults. For instance, as of April 1, 2026, the CDS spread on the 10-

IN SHORT

- Rising CoE would mean valuation contraction, in theory
- CoE has risen since December 2025
- More uncertainty to earnings growth forecasts now than in recent years

year Indian government bond was 1.02 per cent, and the bond yield stood at 6.96 per cent. Adjusting for this spread gives a risk-free rate of 5.94 per cent. Damodaran takes this a step further. He suggests using only the incremental CDS spread over that of an Aaa-rated sovereign. The CDS spread on a 10-year Swiss government bond (Aaa-rated) was about 0.17 per cent. The incremental spread for India, therefore, works out to 0.85 per cent (1.02 minus 0.17), yielding a risk-free rate of 6.11 per cent.

However, this approach is possible only if there is an active CDS market for the currency. In case of its absence, he offers an alternative — use the CDS spread of a similarly rated sovereign. India's sovereign rating by Moody's is Baa3, and the CDS spread for a Baa3-rated government bond then was about 2.09 per cent. Subtracting this from the Indian 10-year yield gives a risk-free rate of 4.87 per cent (6.96 minus 2.09).

Since we rely on Damodaran's dataset (available consistently since 2001), we use this second approach in our analysis. Link to dataset tinyurl.com/2akfpzyp > Risk Premiums for Other Markets.

EQUITY RISK PREMIUM
ERP ($R_m - R_f$) measures the additional return investors demand from equities over the risk-free rate. A simple way to estimate R_m is to use historical equity returns, but this assumes the future will replicate the past.

Damodaran instead adopts a forward-looking approach, computing an internal rate of return that discounts future cash flows (dividends and buybacks) of a broad market index to its current level.

Damodaran treats ERP as a sum of two independent components:

(A) Mature market ERP — compensation for inherent risk of equities, irrespective of geography

(B) Country risk premium — compensation for operating in a specific market or geography

For the mature market, he uses the US and the S&P 500 because the index offers robust historical data and liquidity. However, since May 2025, the US is no longer an Aaa-rated sovereign and has been downgraded to Aa1. Yet Damodaran sticks to the S&P 500 with a minor additional adjustment for this rating downgrade, as there is no equivalent broader market index in other Aaa-rated countries.

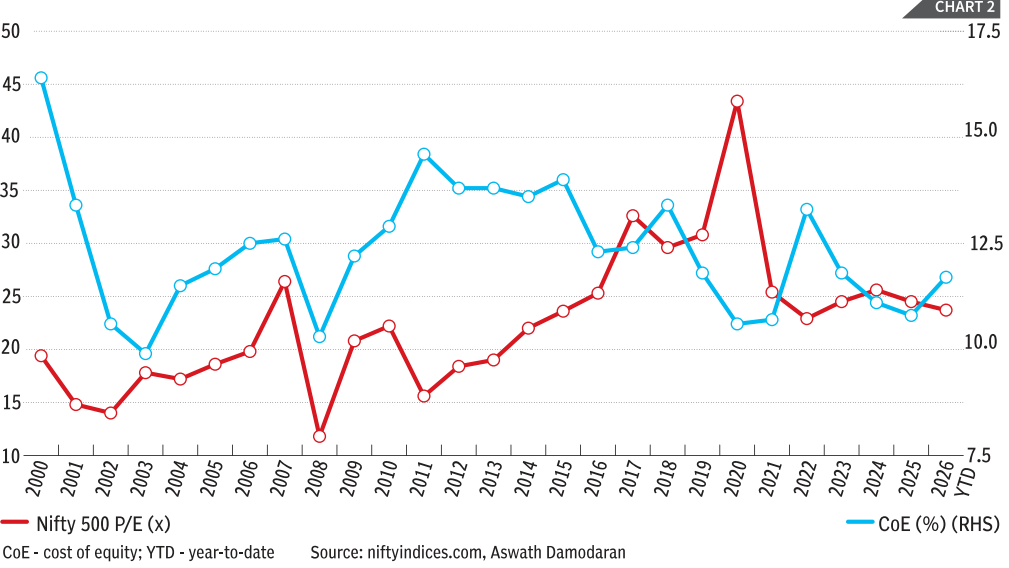
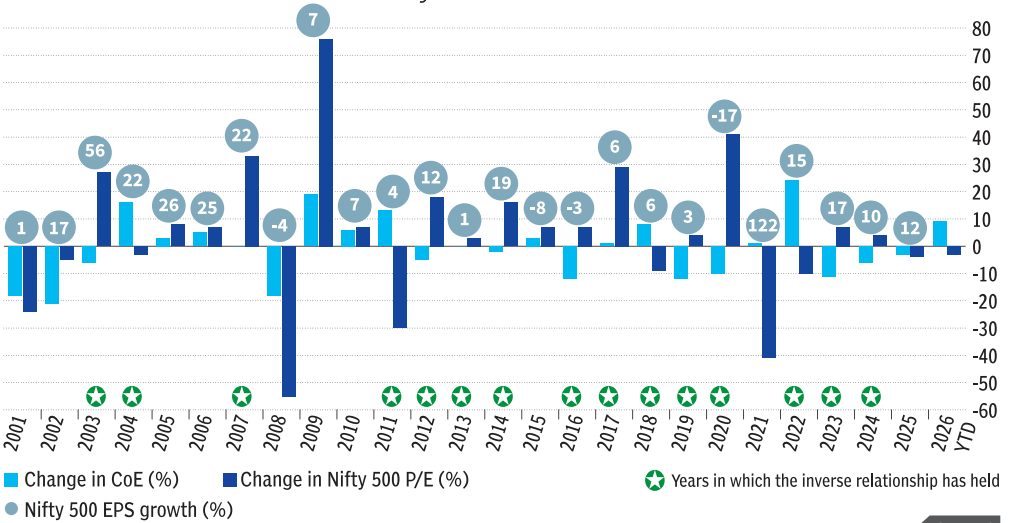
Let us walk through how he calculates ERP for an emerging market like India, as of April 1, 2026, for instance.

First, for R_m , with estimates of S&P 500's cash flows (dividends and buybacks) for the next five years and a terminal value (estimated to grow at the t-bond rate till perpetuity) Damodaran arrives at an IRR (internal rate of return) of 9.1 per cent that discounts these cash flows to the current value of the index. IRR is basically the discount rate that equates the present value of future cash flows to the current price of an asset. This forward-looking IRR serves as the R_m .

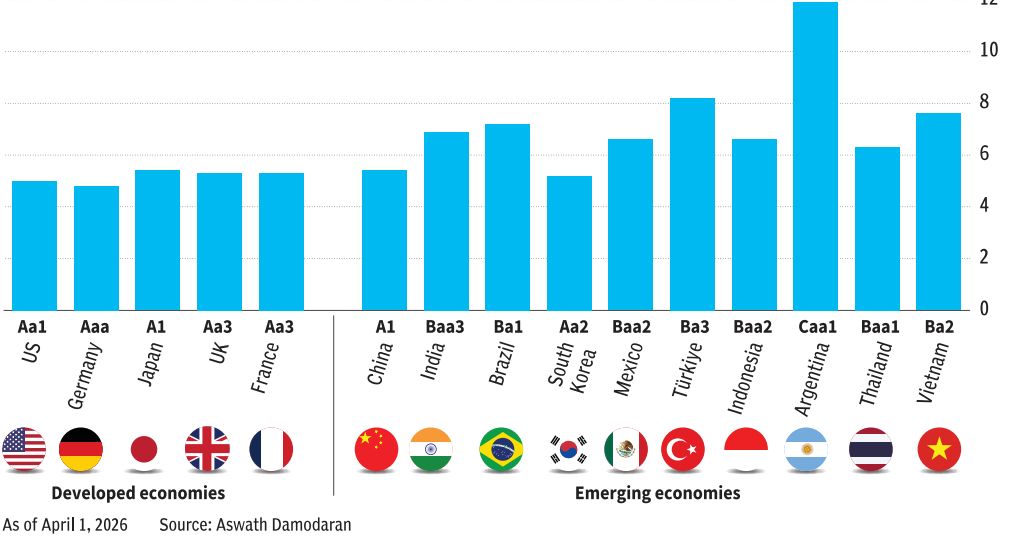
Next up, ordinarily, one would use the 10-year US Treasury yield (4.3 per cent) as the R_f . However, since the US is no longer Aaa-rated, its Treasury yield includes a rating premium over that offered by a Aaa-rated sovereign. The CDS spread for an Aa1-rated sovereign (US) was about 0.26 per cent. Adjusting for this, the true risk-free rate becomes 4.06 per cent, yielding a US ERP of 5.04 per cent (9.1 minus 4.06). However, this is still not the mature market ERP ('A' from above). This 5.04 per cent includes a small US-specific country risk premium ('B' for US) of 0.26 per cent (CDS spread). Removing this gives the pure mature market ERP, which works out to 4.78 per cent (A).

Next comes India's country risk premium (India's 'B'). Damodaran largely suggests us-

Valuation and CoE inversely related



ERP of major economies (%)



ing the same CDS spread used to compute the risk-free rate earlier — in this case 2.09 per cent. While this addresses the sovereign risk of the currency, other emerging-market risks are left to be modelled only through cash flows, avoiding double counting of risks. Adding A and B, India's ERP works out to 6.87 per cent (4.78 plus 2.09). Summing up, with R_f at 4.87 per cent, ERP at 6.87 per cent, the CoE works out to 11.74 per cent as of January 1, 2026. Of course, ERP has to be multiplied with β , when working with a portfolio that is smaller than the broader market portfolio. However, since we have worked with the broader Nifty 500, we have skipped β here.

THEORY HOLDS?

It should now be clear that there exists an inverse relationship between CoE and valuation. To see if this theory holds, we have constructed charts 1 and 2. Chart 1 maps the change in Nifty 500's P/E (as of calendar year-ends) and the change in CoE for all calendar years since 2001. Chart 2 shows the absolute values of the index's P/E and CoE (as of year-ends).

It can be seen from Chart 1 that the inverse relationship has largely held—in years where CoE has fallen or stayed flat, P/E has

expanded and vice-versa. Still, there are exceptions because valuation is influenced not only by CoE but also by earnings growth, sentiment and liquidity. While earnings growth can be quantified, sentiment and liquidity are harder to measure. For instance, 2021 was an outlier: CoE was unchanged, yet the P/E contracted over 40 per cent — from 43x (December 2020) to 25x (December 2021), as EPS surged 122 per cent from a low base in 2020.

On the other hand, in 2008, after the global financial crisis, investors flocked to the safety of government bonds, bringing down R_f and eventually CoE. Ideally, valuation should have expanded. However, P/E contracted 55 per cent owing to a bearish sentiment.

Let's now focus on 2026. CoE has increased 9 per cent so far, from 10.8 per cent (January 1) to 11.7 per cent (April 1 - date of Damodaran's latest release). Valuation, on the other hand, has contracted just 3 per cent, leading one to doubt if the market is underpricing risks. If it is doing so, a late realisation could take the valuation multiple downward.

With the conflict in West Asia yet to come to a meaningful conclusion, the cost of oil remains el-

evated and highly volatile, adversely impacting India's current account deficit, currency and inflation. It is reasonable to expect night and day difference between the average cost of Indian crude basket in FY27 (April 2026 average was \$114, for context) versus FY26 (\$71 a barrel). This could erode margins of sectors such as FMCG, paints, logistics, chemicals, tyres, castings & forgings, and others that are dependent on petroleum-based inputs. Elsewhere, base-metal prices are rising, AI disruption is real and rural consumption remains heavily weather-dependent, with El Niño and a potential rainfall-deficit posing downside risks. Financial stocks could see higher credit costs driven by possible defaults in MSME and commercial vehicle loans, denting earnings.

All these imply more uncertainty to earnings growth forecasts than in recent years. When you combine higher CoE and earnings uncertainty, you must take note that a Nifty 50 P/E of 22x now is not the same as in another past year when it was trading at the same level. Factor this in your investment decisions. In this context, if earnings growth falters and thus valuations become expensive, a correction could follow sooner or later.

TAX QUERY.



SANJIV CHAUDHARY

Under the non-government NPS rules, up to 80 per cent of the accumulated corpus can be withdrawn as a lumpsum, of which only 60 per cent is exempt from tax. Assuming a total corpus of ₹1 crore, if I withdraw ₹80 lakh as a lumpsum, ₹20 lakh would be taxable. My understanding is that tax should be levied only on the capital gains component included in this ₹20 lakh, and not on the entire ₹20 lakh. Kindly confirm whether this interpretation is correct and advise on the

applicable tax treatment.
Vijaykumar V, Pune

As per Schedule II read with Section 124 of the Income-tax Act 2025 [earlier section 10(12A) of the Income-tax Act, 1961], up to 60 per cent of the total NPS corpus withdrawn at the time of closure/exit after (after age of 60) is exempt from tax, and the balance portion is taxable. Accordingly, in our example (₹1 crore corpus with ₹80 lakh withdrawn), ₹60 lakh is exempt; the remaining ₹20 lakh is fully taxable. It is pertinent to note that unlike mutual funds, no distinction is made between principal and gains for NPS withdrawals. This is because NPS does not follow capital gains taxation principles—it is a deferred taxation regime, where:



Contributions may have received tax benefits earlier, and accretions are not taxed annually. Therefore, the withdrawal (beyond the exempt 60 per cent) is taxed as income, not as capital gains.

The entire taxable portion is treated as "Income from Other Sources" and taxed at the applicable slab rates. Therefore, the understanding that only the capital gains component within the ₹20 lakh would be taxable is

not in line with the current provisions.

Further, the remaining balance of 20 per cent of the corpus (₹1 crore – ₹80 lakh = ₹20 lakh) standing in the NPS account, is required to be utilised for purchase of an annuity plan. The tax implications in respect of the annuity are as follows:

* At the time of purchase of annuity: The amount utilised for purchase of the annuity is not taxable.

* During the pension phase: The annuity/pension received periodically (monthly/quarterly/annually) is taxable in the hands of the recipient at the applicable slab rates in the year of receipt.

The author is a practising chartered accountant

Small Savings Schemes - Interest rates

Small Savings Scheme	Interest rate (%)		Compounding frequency
	Jan 1 - Mar 31, 2026	Apr 1 - Jun 30, 2026	
Post Office Savings Deposit	4.0	4.0	Annually
	1 year	6.9	Quarterly
	2 year	7.0	Quarterly
	3 year	7.1	Quarterly
Post Office Time Deposit	5 year	7.5	Quarterly
	Post Office Recurring Deposit (5 year)	6.7	Quarterly
Senior Citizen Savings Scheme	8.2	8.2	Quarterly and paid
Post Office Monthly Income Scheme	7.4	7.4	Monthly and paid
National Savings Certificate	7.7	7.7	Annually
Public Provident Fund	7.1	7.1	Annually
Kisan Vikas Patra	7.5*	7.5*	Annually
Sukanya Samridhi Yojana	8.2	8.2	Annually

Note: Small savings rate as on the latest quarterly reset on March 30, 2026
#Will mature in 115 months Source: Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, Govt of India

Enough room for re-rating

HOSPITALITY. SAMHI Hotels is now profitable, finance costs are falling & valuation is attractive if one can stomach the risks

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Amid the West Asia war-related disruption and impact on economy, inflation and stock markets, the structural long-term cycle in India's hotel sector continues to remain favourable. In this context, SAMHI Hotels requires a re-look.

When branded hotel ownership firm SAMHI came out with its IPO in September 2023 at ₹126 a share, our view was clear: investors can avoid the IPO. While SAMHI had scale, global hotel brands (Marriott, Hyatt, IHG), urban business-hotel exposure and an acquisition-led turnaround model, the company was still loss-making, carried high debt (proforma at the time of IPO: over ₹2,800 crore, debt/adj. EBITDA 11x) and finance costs (at 59 per cent of revenue) were negatives amid a strong hotel upcycle.

Since then, the stock has had a full cycle of enthusiasm and correction. It touched a peak of about ₹255, and a bottom of ₹120 in 2025. It now trades at ₹157.45. From IPO price, it is up 25 per cent, better than the Sensex (up 16 per cent), but has underperformed Indian Hotels (up 56 per cent), EIH (up 41 per cent) and Chalet Hotels (up 34 per cent). SAMHI's 38 per cent correction from peak, & improving fundamentals makes risk-reward more interesting now.

At the current price and based on FY27 consensus earnings estimate per Bloomberg, SAMHI trades at a one-year forward PE of 14.6 times, less than two times price-to-book and around 9.3 times EV/EBITDA (was 16x during IPO). All these are quite lower than peers. Its forward P/E now is around 40 per cent discount to its own two-year average of about 24 times.

Having said that, the stock is not without risk, but the business is no longer the same leveraged, loss-making IPO story. Investors with a three-five-year perspective can accumulate the stock on dips, but only in small quantities, given the relatively-small m-cap of around ₹3,500 crore and still-meaningful debt (debt/adj. EBITDA at 4x), although leverage risk is significant-



antly lower than during IPO.

WHAT HAS CHANGED

SAMHI Hotels currently has a portfolio of over 6,500 rooms. Out of this, about 4,900 rooms are operational across 31 hotels. The company's business model encompasses its acquisition and turnaround-led approach. SAMHI leverages the power of strong hotel brands, enjoys a strong demand base thanks to presence in high-density micro-markets. Its proprietary tools (SAMHIIntel, SAMConnect) help performance & efficiency.

The first major change is turnaround in bottomline profitability (see chart). At the time of the IPO, SAMHI had scaled up but had not shown sustained profitable growth (losses in FY21, FY22 and FY23). That has changed. The company reported adj. PAT of ₹99.1 crore in FY25 and over ₹216 crore for trailing twelve months (TTM). Due to low base, quarterly PAT numbers optically show sharp growth. The direction is important, quarterly PAT has remained positive since Q4FY24.

The second change is debt and interest cost (see chart). This was the biggest concern during the IPO. Debt has not disappeared, but it has moved in the right direction. At the time of the IPO, SAMHI wanted to cut loans, especially the high-cost ones. Total debt has come down from around ₹2,690 crore in FY23 to about ₹1,726 crore in the TTM period. Finance cost declined by around one-third year on year to ₹40.3 crore in Q3FY26. Loan interest rate is now 8.3 per cent vs. 9.7 per cent in FY24. SAMHI can fund its annual capex outlay primarily through internal accruals.

The third change is operating momentum (see chart). SAM-

ACCUMULATE

SAMHI Hotels ₹157.45

WHY

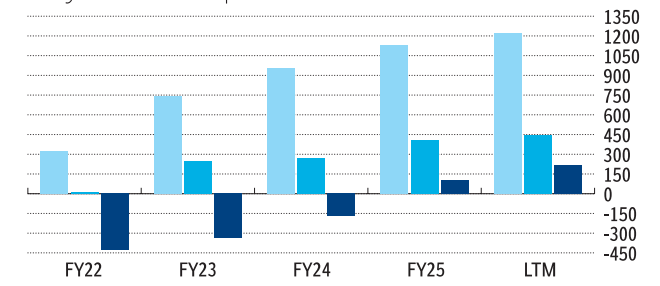
- Valuation discount after sharp correction
- Profits now replacing IPO-era losses
- Premiumisation plus asset-light leisure optionality

IH's Q3FY26 same-store Revenue Per Available Room (RevPAR) grew 13.3 per cent, while total income rose 16.2 per cent. For 9MFY26, total income grew 13.5 per cent and consolidated EBITDA rose 15.2 per cent. The company did face a GST-related margin hit after the removal of input tax credit for hotels with room rates below ₹7,500, but even after this impact, consolidated EBITDA margin in Q3 stood at a healthy 36.9 per cent. SAMHI expects GST impact to fade in the medium term.

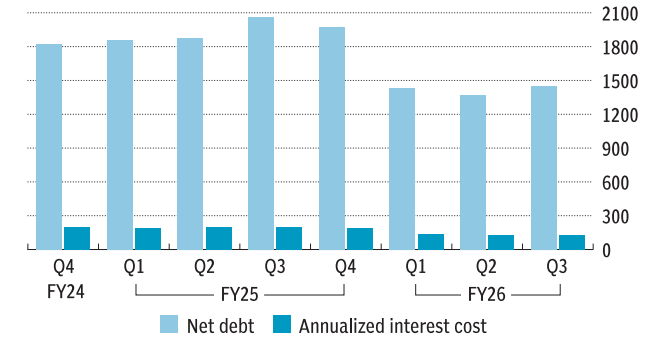
The fourth change is portfolio quality. SAMHI is moving up the chain. Ongoing rebranding and renovations are expected to increase the revenue share of up-per upscale and upscale hotels from about 42 per cent now to about 60 per cent after projects are completed. This matters because the premium portfolio earns much higher room rates.

A fifth, and newer, positive is SAMHI's move into a more capital-light growth route. Its proposed 70 per cent acquisition (for ₹47 crore) of luxury hospitality platform RARE India gives it exposure to experiential leisure without buying the underlying hotels. RARE gives access to 67 hotels & 990 rooms across In-

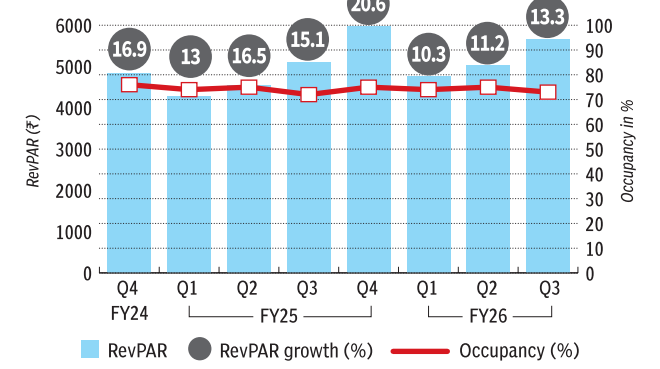
Key financial parameters



Reducing leverage



Performance indicators



Source: Bloomberg, Investor presentation, Press releases

dia, Nepal and Bhutan. It has no owned hospitality assets. RARE earns B2B listing fees, but can build B2C commission income upon integration with Marriott's ecosystem. RARE does not change the core business overnight, but adds optionality.

WHAT NEEDS WATCHING

Debt remains the main risk. The direction is better, but absolute debt is still high relative to profits and market capitalisation. A company with a market value of about ₹3,500 crore and net debt ₹1,450 crore cannot be treated like a risk-free hotel compounder such as IHCL. Any

slowdown in ARR (average room rate) growth, occupancy or asset ramp-up can again expose the balance sheet. The second risk is execution. The company has a large pipeline and multiple rebranding projects. These can lift revenue and later margins, but delays or cost overruns can hurt. The pipeline consists of a mix of new hotel openings, rebranding of existing assets and expansions of currently operational properties.

The other risk is cyclicality. Hotels are enjoying a strong up-cycle. If the cycle weakens, smaller leveraged players can correct faster.

Hold while it cements its position

CEMENT. The Ramco Cements is at a position where revenue growth prospects are, to an extent, offset by margin pressures

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

The Ramco Cements is a South-based cement manufacturer with an installed capacity of 24 mtpa (million tonnes per annum). The company derives 75 per cent of its revenues from the South and 25 per cent from the eastern markets. It has a strong growth outlook, supported by capital expansion, though margin could come under pressure. In October 2022, we had given an 'Accumulate' rating on the stock when it was trading at ₹698 per share and a valuation of one-year forward PE of 24.3 times and one-year forward EV/EBITDA 13.5 times.

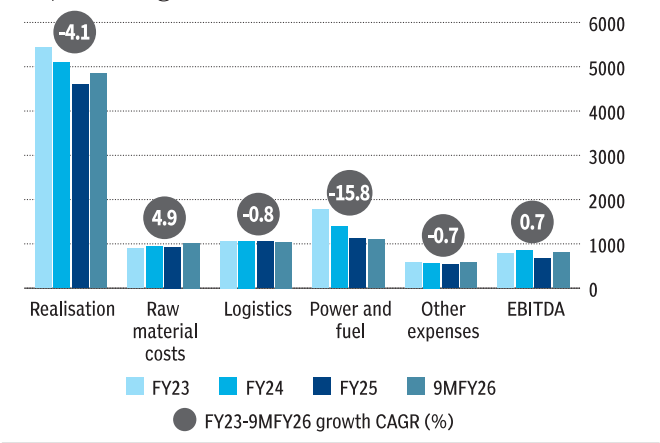
Today, the stock is trading at a premium valuation of 40 times one-year forward earnings (33 per cent premium to last five-year average) or 14 times one-year forward EV/EBITDA (in line). Considering the rich valuations and margin pressures as measured against growth prospects, we recommend investors 'hold' the stock, and avoid adding fresh positions for now.

REVENUE DRIVERS

The company's cement realisations were on a declining trend during FY23-25 and after bottoming out, have recovered by 4.5 per cent in 9MFY26. Factoring these, the overall decrease in realisations for FY23-9MFY26 is at a CAGR of 4 per cent, similar to the Indian cement industry realisations. However, despite the weak base of cement prices combined with strong demand from housing and national infrastructure plan, only a nominal growth of 1-2 per cent year on year can be expected in the next two years. This is because the southern market will remain a region with overcapacity in cement production. The company reported 1 per cent growth in cement realisations in



Operating metrics



Q3FY26 and recovery in prices faced competitive pressures. With other South-based players such as India Cements, Sanghi and Penna now acquired by larger players — UltraTech and Ambuja, expansion and production debottlenecking is underway at those plants.

Ramco is also expanding capacity, which should support revenue growth even if pricing remains weak. It plans to raise capacity from 24.4 mtpa to 31 mtpa by FY28, including 3 mtpa from debottlenecking existing plants and 3 mtpa from a brownfield expansion at its Andhra Pradesh plant. The debottlenecking is expected to be completed shortly, and the brownfield expansion by FY27-end. Improving utilisation at the ex-

panded facilities is another lever for growth. Capacity utilisation was 83 per cent in FY24, but fell to 77 per cent in FY25 after the company added 2 mtpa (taking capacity to 24.4 mtpa). Utilisation may dip further as new capacity comes on stream; however, over the longer term, a return to the historical level of about 80 per cent could support higher volumes.

The company has also launched the construction chemicals segment in FY25 which accounted for 4.2 per cent of Q3FY26 revenues, and the segment reported 73 per cent growth.

Overall, the company should deliver 12-13 per cent revenue growth in FY26-28, supported primarily by capacity expansion.

HOLD

The Ramco Cements ₹958.50

WHY

- Volume growth through capacity expansion
- Cost structure remains under pressure
- Premium valuations

MARGIN HEADWINDS

While the revenue outlook is strong, margin outlook is not. The company, like the cement/steel industry, is coming off from a period of input cost deflation. For Ramco Cements, this was led by power and fuel costs, which declined at 16 per cent CAGR (power and fuel cost per tonne) in FY23-9MFY26. This is owing to the deflation in coking coal costs and higher proportion of renewable energy in production. The company reported green energy share in total energy consumed at 47 per cent in Q3FY26 compared to 39 per cent last year. This is expected to rise further, as it hopes to add a 15-MW solar plant as well in the capex plan.

But coking coal costs are expected to rise and have already started rising from late-2025. This will be further amplified by the current US-Iran conflict, which will increase the shipping costs. The risk premium added to crude oil, even assuming a resolution to the conflict, will structurally increase the cost of imported coal for all users as coking coal is imported from Australia, in addition to that sourced domestically.

While other operating costs have declined as shown in the table, raw material costs have grown at 5 per cent CAGR in the FY23-9MFY26 period. This can be ascribed to the ₹160-per-tonne addition to limestone

sourced from Tamil Nadu from FY25 on account of a levy (mineral bearing land tax). The levy is close to 20 per cent of 9MFY26 EBITDA per tonne.

Owing to declining realisations and increasing raw material costs, Ramco's EBITDA per tonne has been flattish in the same period. The consensus estimates of ₹1,000 per tonne by FY28 are reliant on waiver of the mineral tax, and contained power and fuel costs. The expectation also relies on higher green energy share and operating leverage from a higher capacity and improved utilisation; we expect these are more likely to be realised.

FINANCIALS

The company reported a 5 per cent year-on-year revenue growth in 9MFY26 to ₹6,418 crore, but profit growth of 163 per cent to ₹163 crore, owing to improved realisations and power costs remaining lower. It has a net debt to EBITDA of 2.8 times in December 2025, which has improved from 3.5 times in March 2025. The reduction has been driven by disposal of non-core assets of close to ₹1,000 crore in the last two years. The company has earmarked ₹200 crore more for disposal shortly. The next leg of capital expenditure includes debottlenecking and brownfield expansion, which should be low-cost.

Overall, Ramco Cements is at a position where revenue growth prospects are, to an extent, offset by margin pressures. At the same time, valuation at one-year forward EV/EBITDA of 14 times is not excessive, while at the same time not cheap, given its relatively-smaller size and regional focus in an industry dominated by UltraTech and Ambuja.

Peers UltraTech, Ambuja and Shree Cements trade at 18.6, 16 and 15 times respectively. Considering these, the risk-reward appears balanced.

businessline's editorial policy prohibits analysts from taking positions in the stocks they recommend — Editor

GLOBAL BOARDROOM CHATTER.

What they say on their India plans

With India being the fastest growing large economy, 'what is your India plan?' is a common topic in boardrooms of most global corporations. One important source to distil their India plans is from their quarterly earnings calls. With the March quarter earnings season in progress, this column will present what CXOs of global corporations are saying about India, along with their perspectives and plans during the current earnings season. Here are some from companies that reported their earnings last week.

Monster Beverage Corporation (MNST, m-cap \$74.3 billion)

The US energy drink maker reported exceptionally strong growth in India, driven by rising demand and expansion of affordable offerings.

"Net sales in India surged 94.5 per cent in dollar terms and more than doubled on a currency-neutral basis in Q1 2026. We remain highly optimistic about the long-term growth prospects for our brands in India and the broader Asia Pacific region."

Anheuser-Busch InBev SA/NV (BUD, \$155.3 billion)

The global brewer described India as a consistently growing beer market with long-term potential.

"India has been a strong growth story for the beer industry, with the market continuing to expand steadily despite periodic fluctuations."

Marriott International, Inc. (MAR, \$92.8 billion)

The global hotel operator highlighted its dominant position in India amid evolving global travel dynamics.

"Marriott remains the largest hotel company in India, and shifts in West Asia transit traffic are particularly relevant given our strong footprint in the market."

KKR & Co. Inc. (KKR, \$89.3 billion)

The global investment firm said it remains confident on India despite concerns around outsourcing-linked employment trends.

"We have reviewed our India portfolio closely and do not see elevated risks. Our focus remains on infrastructure, electricity grids and digitalisation opportunities tied to AI deployment, areas where we see strong long-term potential in India."

Cameco Corporation (CCJ, \$51.7 billion)

The Canadian uranium producer said India remains a key long-term buyer in the global nuclear fuel market.

"Our long-negotiated India deal reflects strong sovereign demand for uranium under market-linked contracts. India, alongside China, continues to play an important role in shaping the global term market."

Transocean Ltd (RIG, \$6.9 billion)

The offshore drilling company highlighted India's growing commitment to energy exploration and offshore investment.

"ONGC and Oil India are expected to expand the regional offshore fleet significantly by 2027, potentially adding 20 rig years. India's push to assess and develop domestic offshore reserves reflects a major multi-year investment commitment."

GATX Corporation (GATX, \$6.5 billion)

The railcar leasing company highlighted strong demand conditions in India driven by policy support and economic growth.

"Policy support and economic expansion continue to drive robust railcar demand in India, where GATX Rail India maintained 100 per cent fleet utilisation during the quarter."

Wallenius Wilhelmsen ASA (WAWI, Nkr47.1 billion)

The Norwegian shipping group said India is emerging as an increasingly important manufacturing and export hub for heavy equipment.

"Customers are increasingly viewing India as a global production hub for high and heavy equipment. While still early days, we are closely monitoring the growth in exports from India."

Sinch AB (publ) (SINCH, Skr25.7 billion)

The Swedish cloud communications company said India remains a competitive but strategically important market.

"India remains challenging but represents only a low single-digit share of group profit. We are focused on stabilising and returning the business to growth, given the market's massive long-term potential with over one billion mobile subscribers."

Schneider Electric S.E. (SU, €154.7 billion)

The French industrial technology company is strengthening India as a key global hub for operations, R&D and supply chain capabilities.

"India now supports Schneider Electric's international hub strategy, leveraging the R&D, software and supply chain capabilities built through our L&T Electrical & Automation acquisition. This strengthens our ability to scale globally alongside sustained growth."

Contributed by NAFA ASSET MANAGERS

WHO AM I?.

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here's a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

- I have a history of over 100 years in home delivery of my products and still carry my founder's name as my brand. I got listed in the 1980s.
- My annual revenues crossed ₹1,000 crore only in recent years.
- My founding family had internal conflicts for several years and undertook a sweeping restructuring last year, resulting in the appointment of a new professional CEO.
- My recently-appointed CEO, an IIM Calcutta alumnus, used to run one of my biggest competing brands. His high compensation was cited as one of the reasons for my Chairman's resignation.
- I have delivered more than 20 per cent CAGR returns to shareholders over the last three, five and 10 years.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to who-am-i@thehindu.co.in, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

Contributed by UNIFI CAPITAL

Last week's stock: M M Forgings
Last week's winner: Harpreet Singh

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. Research Bureau

Nifty 50 (24,176) and Nifty Bank (55,311) appreciated 0.7 per cent and 0.8 per cent, respectively, over the past week. The futures and options data of these indices largely support the bullish view. Below is an analysis.

NIFTY 50
Nifty futures (May) (24,235) held on the support at 24,000 well and on the back of this, the bulls pushed the contract up last week. It posted a gain of 0.6 per cent.

So long as the base at 24,000 holds true, the probability for further rally will remain higher. From the current level, we expect Nifty futures to eventually resume the next leg of rally.

Although 24,750 is a potential hurdle, Nifty futures will most likely surpass this and rise to 25,000 in the near term. A breakout of 25,000 will open the door for an upswing to 26,000.

On the other hand, if the contract breaches the base at 24,000, there is another support at 23,800, which can stop the bears. However, if 23,800 is invalidated, the near-term outlook can turn negative. In such a scenario, Nifty futures can fall to 23,000.

Nevertheless, as it stands, the bulls are defending the support at 24,000 well.

Substantiating the upward bias, the May futures has seen fresh long build-up for the second week in a row. Last week, while it moved up by 0.6 per cent, the outstanding open interest rose from 152 lakh contracts to 171 lakh contracts, showing the arrival of new buyers.

Positioning in options, too, reflects the same sentiment. The Put Call Ratio (PCR) of the May options stood at 1.10 on Friday. A ratio greater than 1 is because of selling of relatively greater number of put options when compared to calls. Traders sell puts when they hold neutral to bullish outlook.



Support keeps bulls ahead

F&O TRACKER. Long build-up across index futures reinforces expectations of another leg of up move

Overall, the price action and the derivatives data show that the bulls hold an advantage and so, further rally this week is highly likely.

Strategy: Hold on to the long position on Nifty futures (May) that we recommended at 24,027. Retain the stop-loss at 23,580. Going ahead, when the contract rises to 24,500 and 24,750, raise the stop-loss to 24,200 and 24,500 respectively. Book profits at 25,000.

For option traders, we suggested buying 24,500-call of May monthly expiry at ₹250. Maintain the stop-loss at ₹80. Target can be ₹600.

NIFTY BANK
Nifty Bank futures (May) (55,516) saw a decline in the first half of last week. It made a low of 54,430 on Tuesday. How-

- TO BE NOTED
- Fresh buyers emerge in May futures
 - Option PCR remains favourable for Nifty
 - Minor hurdles ahead but not risky

ever, since the price region around 55,000 is a support, the lower prices were absorbed by the buyers. In fact, there was a recovery leading to the contract posting a weekly gain of 0.6 per cent.

Given that the support at 55,000 has been holding well for a month now, a decline below this price point is less likely to occur.

We anticipate a recovery

soon, which can lift Nifty Bank futures to 59,000. That said, traders should note that there is a minor resistance at 57,800. While this is unlikely to turn the trend around, we can expect a minor corrective decline or a time correction after the contract rallies to 57,800.

However, if Nifty Bank futures decline from the current level and break down below 55,000, there are notable support levels at 54,600 and 54,000 that can arrest the decline.

That said, if 54,000 is taken out, the outlook can turn bearish, possibly leading to a fall to 52,500.

But at this juncture, Nifty Bank futures' outlook is positive.

The May futures witnessed a long build-up over the last week — as the contract rose 0.6 per

cent, the outstanding open interest increased from 20 lakh contracts to 23.2 lakh contracts.

However, the PCR of May options stood at 0.83, denoting that the option traders appear a little bearish as they have sold more calls than puts, keeping the ratio less than 1.

Overall, the chart shows that key support levels stay valid and the futures have seen a long build-up, giving the bulls some advantage.

Strategy: Go long on Nifty Bank futures (May) at 55,500. Place stop-loss at 53,800. When the contract rises to 58,000, raise the stop-loss to 56,900. Book profits at 59,000.

Option traders can buy 56000-call of May expiry, which closed at ₹701.30 last week. Buy at ₹600. Target and stop-loss can be ₹2,000 and ₹200 respectively.

BTST trades: Futures or options?

MASTERING DERIVATIVES. Volume and market profile will play an important role in identifying BTST trades

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

The increased volatility in the market over the last one year has pushed many individuals to engage in short-term trades. One such trade is 'Buy Today, Sell Tomorrow' (BTST).

This week, we discuss whether you should consider options or futures for BTST trades.

THETA EFFECT
BTST trade typically involves buying during the last 30 minutes of trading with the intent to close the position during the early trade the next day. Now, consider trading options. An option price consists of two components — intrinsic value and time value.

Intrinsic value moves one-to-one with the underlying. But only in-the-money (ITM) options have intrinsic value. All options carry time value, which decreases with each passing day. The loss in time value is referred to as theta or time decay.

This is the reason why option

- MANAGING CALLS
- It is important that you initiate a BTST trade with stop-loss trigger to moderate the downside risk

prices cannot move one-to-one with the underlying.

Futures do not suffer time decay. Therefore, theta becomes the primary factor deciding between futures and options for BTST trade.

Note that theta impacts an option price on daily basis, not intraday. That means if you hold an option position overnight, the price of the option will be lower the next day, if the underlying price, interest rate and volatility remain the same. These factors are held constant in an option valuation model to show the effect of the loss in time value per day.

The above discussion shows that even if the underlying were to move up as expected, an option cannot offer maximum



profit potential because of theta. This sets up a clear bias towards futures. A long BTST trade is initiated only if you expect the underlying to move up sharply the next day.

The directional bias and the confident view of the price movement lends itself to a futures trade. This is because fu-

tures price can move nearly one-to-one with the underlying.

Of course, there is high downside risk. Overnight trades are exposed to high level of systematic risk. This is the risk that the market can tank because of negative news that flows in before the exchange opens for trading the next day. It is, therefore, im-

portant that you initiate a BTST trade with stop-loss trigger to moderate the downside risk. This is also another reason why futures are beneficial compared to options. It is not so easy to arrive at an appropriate stop on options; you must use an option valuation model to forecast the option price if the underlying were to move adversely at opening trade the next day.

OPTIONAL READING
BTST trades require astute reading of the chart. The objective is to identify a list of underlyings that have momentum with strong likelihood that the price will move up in early trade the next day.

Among other factors, volume and market profile will play an important role in identifying BTST trades. Note that you must identify momentum on a lower time-frame, say, 5-to 15-minute charts preferably on the futures prices.

The author offers training programmes for individuals to manage their personal investments

Oil futures price could even hit \$140

CRUDE CHECK. Brent futures and MCX crude futures hold above key supports despite heightened volatility

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Oil prices hit record highs on prevailing supply-side risks. While the fundamentals highlight many uncertainties, here's what charts tell us:

BRENT FUTURES (\$101.29)
The contract began 2026 on a strong footing as it saw a notable uptick in January, even before the war broke out. It had surpassed a falling trendline resistance at around \$63 in January. After some consolidation in the first half of February, the contract saw a sharp rally and hit a four-year high of \$119.50 on March 9.

But since then, Brent crude oil futures has been trading in a broad sideways trend, between \$94 and \$115, accompanied by high volatility and consequently witnessing price swings of both

sides within the range.

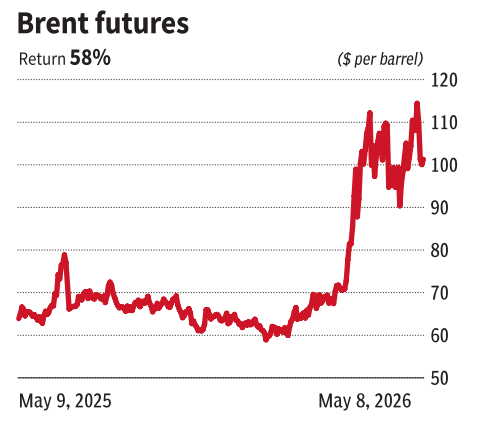
Although currently, the contract is in a broad range, there is an upward bias, as the support at \$94 holds true and the price is above 21- and 50-day moving averages.

In case Brent crude futures gathers enough strength to break out of \$115 and manage to witness a weekly close above it, we will most likely see another leg-up, potentially lifting the price to \$128 and \$140, as indicated by Fibonacci extensions.

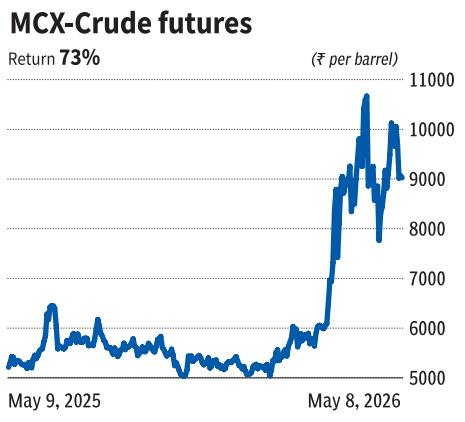
But if the bears gain traction and drag Brent crude futures below the base at \$94, the near-term outlook can turn weak. In this case, the downswing can extend to \$88 quickly.

A breakdown below this can lead to a fall to \$80.

As it stands, the bias is bullish and \$128 appears a realistic target. However, the volatility is expected to remain at elevated levels.



MCX-CRUDE FUTURES (₹9,024)
Like Brent crude futures, crude oil futures in the domestic market looked positive since the start of the year. The rally exploded towards the end of February, which took the contract to ₹10,549 on March 9 in the first swing. Then, unlike Brent

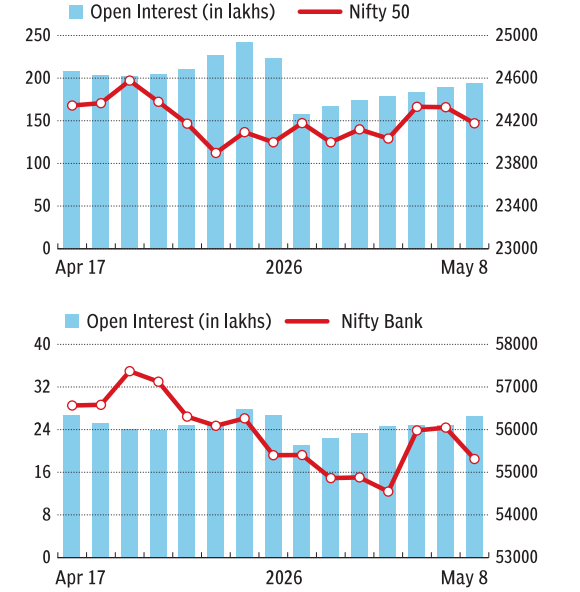


crude futures, MCX crude futures witnessed another leg-up and hit a life-time high of ₹10,990 on April 7. The prevailing price action shows that the bulls have not exhausted the fuel. Key support levels are at ₹8,500 and ₹8,000. The latter is the key price-point from the outlook perspective. That is, un-

til this level holds, the positive inclination will persist. A regain in traction for the bulls can lead to MCX crude oil futures to fresh highs, with potential barriers at ₹12,000 and ₹12,400.

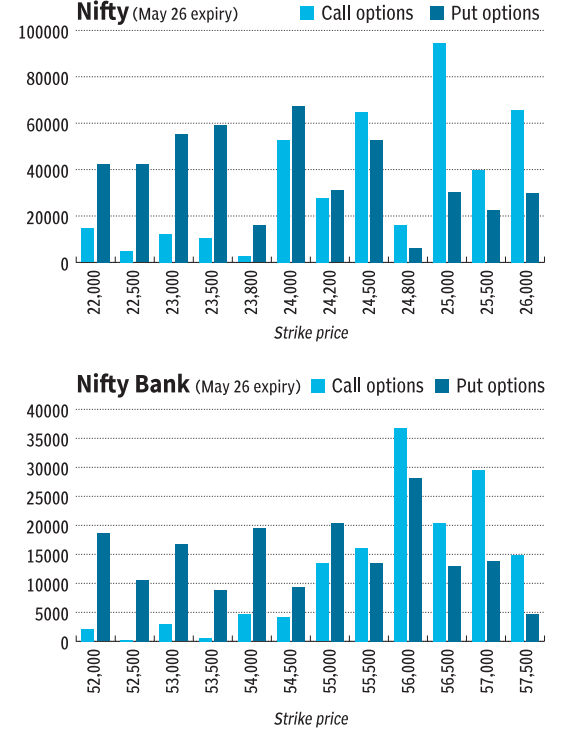
In case of weakness build-up, leading to the breach of the support at ₹8,000, the contract can fall to ₹7,500 or even to ₹6,750.

Cumulative Open Interest (Futures)



Open Interest chain (as on May 8)

Put-Call ratio Nifty **1.10** | Nifty Bank **0.83**



Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on May 8	Weekly change %	As on May 8	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	34616	26	236329	15
Future Index Short	244728	15	86420	14
Net Futures	-210112	14	149909	15
Index Call options Long	472541	34	2956938	27
Index Call options Short	722675	26	2766242	26
Net Call options	-250134	14	190696	50
Index Put options Long	817039	14	2140675	28
Index Put options Short	431086	21	2884175	21
Net Put Options	385953	7	-743500	4

FII's have increased net short on index futures. They've also increased net short on calls and net long on puts. Overall, FII positioning shows a bearish tilt.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on May 8)				
VEDL	296.45	9.2	1035.9	176.2
NUVAMA	1,631.50	23.0	53.0	163.6
DILITIND	1,476.00	7.3	183.9	120.0
KPITTECH	729.15	-3.9	201.9	116.7
SBIN	1,019.30	-4.6	2766.2	99.8
FALL (as on May 8)				
PERSISTENT	5,113.60	6.5	59.6	-8.4
SHRIRAMFIN	1,007.75	7.5	662.0	-6.3
SAMMAANCAP	148.78	2.9	1348.8	-6.2
KOTAKBANK	380.80	-0.7	2860.1	-5.8
LODHA	962.10	7.2	184.6	-4.6

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on May 11)

Nil

Change in OI and market positioning

Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹)	OI	Indication
		(Weekly change %)		
COMMODITIES (as on May 8)				
ALUMINIUM	29-May	368.4 (-0.1)	3,098 (0)	Short build-up
COPPER	29-May	1,325.0 (3.3)	11,009 (-9)	Short covering
CRUDEOIL	18-May	9,024.0 (-6.6)	10,446 (-32)	Long unwinding
CRUDEOILM	18-May	9,026.0 (-6.6)	34,469 (-27)	Long unwinding
GOLD	5-Jun	1,52,530.0 (0.8)	9,206 (1)	Long build-up
GOLDGUINEA	29-May	1,22,775.0 (0.7)	14,986 (-6)	Short covering
GOLDM	5-Jun	1,52,467.0 (0.7)	43,940 (9)	Long build-up
GOLDPETAL	29-May	15,385.0 (0.7)	1,88,844 (-7)	Short covering
GOLDTEN	29-May	1,52,751.0 (0.8)	32,429 (-8)	Short covering
LEAD	29-May	200.4 (0.5)	293 (1)	Long build-up
NATURALGAS	26-May	261.0 (-1.3)	30,025 (8)	Short build-up
SILVER	3-Jul	2,61,922.0 (4.4)	6,829 (-2)	Short covering
SILVERM	30-Jun	2,64,268.0 (4.1)	18,281 (-4)	Short covering
SILVERMIC	30-Jun	2,64,292.0 (4.1)	52,346 (-9)	Short covering
ZINC	29-May	348.2 (1.4)	1,989 (-9)	Short covering
CURRENCIES (as on May 8)				
USDINR	26-May	94.57 (-0.6)	15,65,471 (1)	Short build-up
EURINR	26-May	111.37 (-0.2)	28,554 (-4)	Long unwinding
GBPINR	26-May	128.71 (0.0)	33,655 (-5)	Long unwinding
JPYINR	26-May	60.46 (-0.6)	403 (178)	Short build-up

Gurumurthy K
bl. Research Bureau

Nifty 50 and Sensex have not gone any where in the past few weeks. The benchmark indices are stuck inside a sideways range over the last three weeks. Nifty Bank index, on the other hand, has managed to sustain well above its support last week. Overall, there is no major change in the broader picture. The outlook remains positive. We expect the Nifty and Sensex to make a bullish breakout of their range and go higher eventually. Nifty Bank index also has good supports to limit the downside from here.

FPIS SELL
The Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) sold Indian equities heavily for the second consecutive week. The equity segment saw a net outflow of \$1.49 billion. FPIs have to start buying Indian equities for the benchmark indices to go higher convincingly.

NIFTY (24,176.15)
Short-term view: A sideways range of 23,600-24,700 is a possibility for some time. A breakout on either side of this range will determine the next move.

Our preference is to see a bullish breakout above 24,700. Such a break can take the Nifty higher to 25,400-25,500.

The short-term outlook will turn negative only if the index breaks below 23,600. If that happens, Nifty can fall to 23,100-23,000 and even 22,400.

Medium-term outlook: The broader picture remains positive. We retain our bullish view of the Nifty rising to 26,500 in the medium term. Failure to breach 26,500 can continue to keep the index in a wide range of 22,000-26,500.

Ideally, we expect to see a bullish breakout above 26,500. Such a break will then clear the way for a fresh rally to 28,000-30,000 in the long term.

This bullish view will go wrong only if Nifty declines below 22,000. That looks less likely in the absence of any new negative trigger.

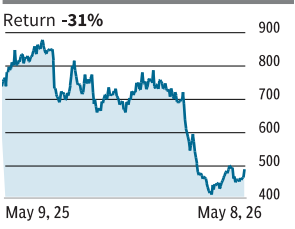
NIFTY BANK (55,310.55)
Short-term view: The support at 54,000 mentioned last week is holding well. But the index seems to lack strength to get a decisive break above 56,000 for now. That keeps the downside open to see 54,000-53,700 in the near-term. A fall below 53,700 looks less likely though.

MOVERS & SHAKERS

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl. research bureau

Hexaware Technologies (₹485.90)

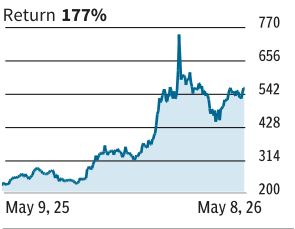
Bullish chart pattern



The stock of Hexaware Technologies has seen a sharp drop in price so far this year, losing about 37 per cent. The tide may be shifting for the scrip as hinted by the recent price action. It has been on a rally since mid-March. After a minor dip in price recently, the stock seems to be readying for the next upswing. While ₹500 is the nearest resistance, we expect the stock to breach this, which will confirm a cup and handle bullish chart pattern. As per this, the upside potential for the stock is ₹600. So, we suggest buying at ₹485 and ₹450. Place stop-loss at ₹420 initially. When the price hits ₹520 and ₹575, tighten the stop-loss to ₹490 and ₹550 respectively. Liquidate at ₹600.

Hindustan Copper (₹569.05)

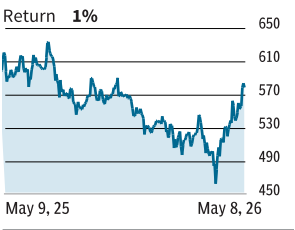
Bull flag pattern seen



The stock of Hindustan Copper bounced off the 21-week moving average last week and posted a gain of 6.4 per cent. The price action since the beginning of April – a rally followed by a consolidation and then a breakout – resembles a bullish flag. As it stands, the probability of a rally is high. While it can reach ₹750 over the next few months, after reaching ₹630, we might see a correction, probably to ₹600, before it eventually breaks out of ₹630. So, participants can go long now at ₹569 and accumulate at ₹540. Place stop-loss at ₹510. When the stock touches ₹630, revise the stop-loss to ₹585. On a rally to ₹700, raise the stop-loss to ₹650. Exit at ₹750.

LIC Housing Finance (₹581.30)

Builds good upward momentum



Since the final week of March, the stock of LIC Housing Finance has been in a steady uptrend. After gaining 12 per cent in April, it is up nearly 5 per cent so far in May. The price is comfortably above both 21- and 50-day moving averages and the breakout of ₹550 a couple of weeks ago shows that there is more upside potential for the stock. That said, the price might moderate to ₹550 before the next upswing. It can reach ₹700 in the medium term. Therefore, one can buy now at ₹581 and accumulate at ₹550. Stop-loss can be ₹520. When the price hits ₹640, alter the stop-loss to ₹600. Revise the stop-loss to ₹640, when the stock rises to ₹675. Book profits at ₹700.



Mired in possibilities

INDEX OUTLOOK. Nifty 50 and Sensex are likely to get a bullish breakout of their range

GETTY IMAGES/STOCKPHOTO

Nifty 50: Stuck in a range



TRADING RANGE

- Nifty 50: 23,600, 24,700
- Sensex: 76,000, 80,000
- Nifty Bank: 53,700-58,500

likely to be a wider range trade that looks to be possible for some time now. Within that, the bias is positive. As such we can expect the Sensex to breach 80,000 and rise to 81,500-82,00.

A fall below 76,000 will only turn the short-term picture negative. If that happens, 73,000 can be seen on the downside.

Medium-term view: Outlook remains bullish. Sensex can see a fresh rise to 86,000 in the medium term.

An extended rise to 90,000 is also a possibility if it manages to surpass 86,000. In case the index turns down from around 86,000, the 71,000-86,000 range can continue to remain intact for some more time.

From a long-term perspective, we see high potential for the Sensex to target 94,000 and even 98,000. This view will go wrong only if the Sensex declines below 71,000.

As long as the index stays above the 54,000-53,700 support zone, the bias will remain positive. Nifty Bank index can rise to 58,500-59,000 in the short term. This rise can happen either from here itself or after a dip to 54,000-53,700. Nifty Bank index has to break 53,700 to come under pressure for more fall to 52,500 and lower.

SENSEX (77,328.19)
Short-term view: Sensex is stuck in a narrow range of 76,250-78,400 over the last two

close above 60,500 will boost the momentum. That in turn can take the Nifty Bank index higher to 64,000-65,000 in the medium term. It will also keep the upside open to see 68,000-69,000 in the long term.

The index has to decline below 50,000 in order to negate this bullish view.

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Upwards and onwards

US MARKET OUTLOOK. Benchmark indices have room to rise

Gurumurthy K
bl. Research Bureau

The S&P 500 and NASDAQ Composite indices surged for the sixth consecutive week. The indices were up 2.33 per cent and 4.51 per cent, respectively. The Dow Jones Industrial Average remained higher but was stable last week. Overall, the US benchmark indices keep their uptrend intact. There is room to rise further going forward.

DOW JONES (49,613.97)
Weekly chart indicates that the index is stuck inside a sideways range of 48,700-50,150. Cluster of supports appear in the 49,000-48,500 region. That leaves the bias positive for the index to make a bullish breakout above 50,100 eventually. Such a break can take the Dow Jones higher to 51,300-51,500 in the coming weeks. It will also keep the upside open to see 52,200 over the medium term.

As mentioned last week, the outlook will turn negative only if the index declines below 48,400. That will bring into the picture the danger of a fall to 46,000-45,000.

For now, our preference is to see a rise to 51,500 and higher.

S&P 500 (7,398.92)
The rise last week indicates that the upmove is gaining momentum. There is no immediate resistance available. So, if the momentum sustains, the rise to 7,600 that we have been expecting can happen immediately. An extended rise to 7,750 is also a possibility. Any intermediate dips can find support in the 7,200-7,100 region. The region around 7,750 is



GETTY IMAGES/STOCKPHOTO

NEAR-TERM DIP

The US 10-year Treasury yield can dip to 4.3-4.25 per cent first and then reverse higher again.

a strong resistance. So, there are good chances for the S&P 500 index to reverse lower towards 7,500-7,400 and even lower after this rise.

NASDAQ COMPOSITE (26,247.08)

The rise to 26,500 is happening in line with our expectation. The strength in the recent rise keeps the chances high for the NASDAQ Composite index to breach 26,500. Such a break can take it further higher to 26,700-26,750, the next important resistance zone.

Failure to rise past 26,750 can trigger a corrective fall. That will have the potential to drag the NASDAQ Composite index down to 25,000 and even 24,000 thereafter.

In case the index manages to breach 26,750, then the

NIFTY MIDCAP 150 (22,772.40)

After two weeks of consolidation, the Nifty Midcap 150 index has resumed its upmove. That keeps intact our overall bullish outlook.

Immediate support is in the 22,700-22,650 region. We expect the index to sustain above this support and go up to 23,000-23,100 in a week or two.

The price action thereafter will need a close watch. A decisive break above 23,100 will strengthen the bullish case. Such a break will clear the way for a rally to 26,000-26,500 first and then to 28,000-28,500 eventually in the long term.

If the index fails to breach 23,100 and declines below 22,650 subsequently, then a fall to 22,300-22,000 is possible. In that case, the 20,800-23,100 range will still remain alive.

The overall picture will turn negative only if the index breaks below 20,800.

NIFTY SMALLCAP 250 (17,437.50)

The rise to 17,500 mentioned last week has happened as expected. There is room to test 17,700 from here. We need to see what happens after that.

Failure to rise above 17,700 and a reversal from there can drag the Nifty Smallcap 250 index down to 17,000-16,500 again.

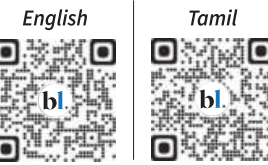
On the other hand, a decisive break above 17,700 can take the index higher to 18,300, the next crucial resistance.

Ideally, the index has to get a sustained rise above 18,300 to gain momentum. Only then the rally to 22,500-23,000 and 24,000 that we have been expecting will come into the picture. Our preference is to see this rally happen eventually, if not immediately.

This long-term bullish view will go wrong only if the Nifty Smallcap 250 index declines below 14,000. That looks unlikely as we see high chances for the index to sustain above 16,000 itself.

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video

Watch **bl. Guru** share the Nifty and Bank Nifty technical outlook for this week



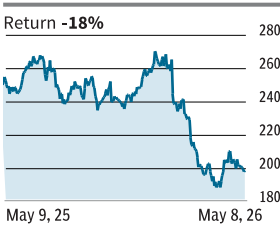
TECH QUERY



GURUMURTHY K, bl. research bureau

I have bought shares of Wipro at ₹188. I am a long-term investor. What are the important levels to watch?

Jhanavi, Guwahati

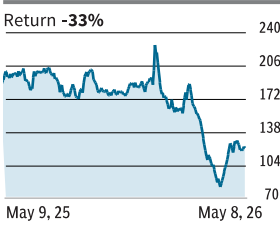


Wipro (₹198): The broader picture is looking weak. The recent bounce from the low of ₹187 made in March seems to lack strength. From a big picture, the stock has to rise past ₹250 in order to turn the

outlook convincingly bullish. Only then a rally to ₹300 and higher levels will come into the picture. The downside remains open to see ₹180-₹185 and even ₹170. If this fall happens, then it will be difficult to get a strong rise back thereafter. So, it is better to exit the stock now with whatever profit you have. Look for some stock that is convincing on the chart for a strong rally from the current levels.

I have shares of Rajesh Exports. My purchase price is ₹120. Can I buy more for long term?

Sudheer, Thrissur

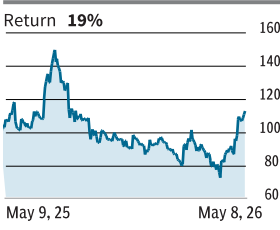


Rajesh Exports (₹122): The stock has been in strong downtrend since February 2023. There is no sign of a reversal yet. Strong resistance is around ₹200. A sustained rise above ₹200 is needed to

indicate a bullish trend reversal. Only then a rise to ₹400 will come into the picture. As long as the stock trades below ₹200, the danger of a fall to ₹50 cannot be ruled out. From 2010 to 2014, there was a prolonged sideways move. If that trend repeats, then a range-bound move between ₹50 and ₹200 is a possibility. Then you may get stuck in this stock for a long time. To avoid that, exit the stock now.

I have bought Haldyn Glass shares bought at ₹95. Shall I hold on to this stock or exit?

Kiran, Ludhiana

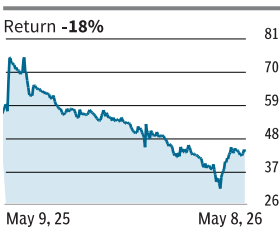


Haldyn Glass (₹114): The stock has seen a strong rise after making a low of ₹70 in March. This is significant as it has happened from a strong long-term trendline support level of ₹68. That gives an

early indication of a bullish trend reversal. Resistance is around ₹122. A strong break above it will turn the outlook bullish. It will then trigger a fresh rally towards ₹220 over the next couple of years. Keep a stop-loss at ₹98. Move the stop-loss up to ₹118 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹128. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹146 and ₹178 when the price touches ₹162 and ₹195, respectively. Exit the longs at ₹210.

I have Tata Teleservices (Maharashtra) Ltd (TTML) shares. My purchase price is ₹51. What is the outlook?

Ravi, Chennai



TTML (₹44): The broader trend has been down since January 2022. Currently, the stock is getting some support around ₹30. Resistance is at ₹52. If the stock manages to breach ₹52, then a rise to ₹65 or even ₹75 is

possible. However, the broader trend will still be down. But failure to breach ₹52 can keep the stock in ₹30-₹52 range for some time. In that case, there is also a danger of the price declining towards ₹20. As seen from the chart, it is not very clear as in which direction the price can go from here. Given the uncertainty and risk of seeing more fall to ₹20, it is better to exit the stock now.

● Send your queries to techtrail@thehindu.co.in

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS.

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all." So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

BANDU'S PICKS	These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week	Last week's prize winner Hena Jabeen
	1 Tejas Networks	Last week's winning stock Vodafone Idea
	2 eClerx Services	Closing price (Apr 30) ₹10.22
	3 Cholamandalam Financial Holdings	Closing price (May 08) ₹11.25
	4 Allied Blenders & Distillers	Return: 10.08 per cent
	5 Motilal Oswal Financial Services	

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to bandublockbuster@gmail.com with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.



Scan to know the winner selection process

Take 500

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businessline.portfolio

SUNDAY - MAY 10 - 2026

Valuation Radar: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The Benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50 were up 0.5 and 0.7 per cent respectively last week. BSE Auto gained the most by 4.9 per cent, followed by BSE Realty 4.6 per cent and BSE Healthcare 4.3 per cent. BSE Oil & Gas and BSE Teck declined the most by 1 and 0.6 per cent respectively last week.

	Nifty 50	Sensex	Auto	Bankex	Capital Goods	Consumer Durables	FMCG	Healthcare	IT	Metal	Oil & Gas	Power	PSU	Realty	Teck
P/E	21.0	20.9	33.5	14.1	58.3	63.4	34.8	40.9	20.8	22.9	9.2	38.0	12.0	38.8	24.2
P/BV	3.3	4.2	6.6	2.3	15.8	16.6	7.9	7.1	5.9	3.9	1.7	5.3	2.4	5.2	7.5
Dividend Yield	1.3	1.2	1.2	1.1	0.4	0.5	1.4	0.5	2.9	0.9	2.8	1.0	2.3	0.4	2.3
Weekly Return (%)	0.7 ▲	0.5 ▲	4.9 ▲	1.0 ▲	3.8 ▲	2.5 ▲	0.6 ▲	4.3 ▲	0.6 ▲	1.3 ▲	-1.0 ▼	1.6 ▲	-0.2 ▼	4.6 ▲	-0.6 ▼
Monthly Return (%)	0.7 ▲	-0.3 ▼	4.5 ▲	-0.6 ▼	15.4 ▲	5.8 ▲	7.8 ▲	10.5 ▲	-6.0 ▼	7.3 ▲	3.3 ▲	17.4 ▲	4.0 ▲	10.6 ▲	-5.3 ▼
Annual Return (%)	-0.4 ▼	-3.7 ▼	18.1 ▲	1.0 ▲	29.6 ▲	7.9 ▲	-6.5 ▼	12.7 ▲	-18.9 ▼	49.6 ▲	4.6 ▲	28.6 ▲	20.7 ▲	-1.8 ▼	-14.1 ▼

The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE.

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Yr-High	Yr-Low	
360 One [1]	11150.9	29.9	37.2	4.6	202603	35.9	15.7	29.9	12.3	-7.7	14.3	0.0	12730.0	861.8	
3M India [1]	32058.3	542.7	59.1	16.8	202606	-0.3	21.6	3.0	23.9	-3.7	39.8	0.0	38300.0	2830.0	
A B B [2]	7009.1	71.9	97.5	19.0	202603	5.8	-25.2	14.8	-3.3	-3.0	9.8	0.1	7825.0	4640.5	
A B Lifestyle [1]	114.0	1.7	66.7	9.9	202603	11.1	-57.4	7.2	29.4	10.9	11.7	0.3	176.1	37.1	
A 889.7 -27.0	4.5	202603	-79.1	-87.8	-66.4	-605.4	0.1	-0.2	1.0	2535.0	180.1				
Aadhar Hsg. Fin.	50.17	25.4	19.7	2.9	202603	18.2	27.0	18.2	21.5	2.6	11.4	2.8	547.8	424.2	
Aarti Industries [5]	485.3	11.4	42.7	3.0	202603	13.1	-42.7	14.1	25.2	-4.3	6.2	0.7	52.9	338.2	
AKASO [1]	140.0	1.5	92.5	26.4	202603	12.3	-5.9	24.2	4.7	9.9	3.2	2552.0	20.4	12.3	
Abbott India	26661.5	717.3	37.2	14.1	202612	6.8	4.2	9.3	14.2	4.8	0.5	0.35921.62514.0			
ACC	1392.0	12.4	112.4	1.3	202603	16.9	-62.9	17.3	-9.0	-2.2	17.9	0.0	2027.8	1250.0	
ACME Solar Hold. [2]	282.7	8.3	34.1	3.4	202603	12.5	0.9	44.0	87.6	-6.7	7.4	2.8	324.3	195.7	
Adani Ports [2]	1760.3	95.3	31.2	4.2	202603	26.5	11.4	27.1	14.9	6.4	16.0	0.9	1790.4	1231.0	
Adani Energy Sol.	1353.6	19.0	71.2	6.4	202603	16.8	5.7	16.1	-6.0	0.8	10.1	2.2	1463.0	745.5	
Adani Enterp. [1]	2505.7	16.7	149.8	4.0	202603	20.3	-124.0	2.6	-48.0	4.2	9.0	1.8	262.8	1753.5	
Adani Green	1355.8	11.2	120.9	11.2	202603	9.1	-40.7	11.6	8.5	10.6	9.4	6.4	1378.0	767.0	
Adani Infra	1760.3	95.3	31.2	4.2	202603	26.5	11.4	27.1	14.9	6.4	16.0	0.9	1790.4	1231.0	
Adani Power [2]	225.2	6.7	33.8	6.7	202603	-0.1	-52.3	-3.5	-0.8	1.4	21.2	0.7	234.4	101.1	
Adani Total Gas [1]	633.7	6.0	106.3	14.3	202603	16.1	8.9	17.9	0.2	-0.2	17.4	0.4	79.74	45.5	
Aditya AMC [5]	1073.4	33.8	31.8	7.7	202603	16.8	-18.0	9.5	5.0	5.7	35.5	0.0	1122.8	611.8	
Aditya Birla F&S	66.3	1.5	44.5	25.0	202603	10.2	29.4	12.1	15.1	5.1	9.5	4.4	37.59	8.9	
Aditya Birla Cap	363.1	14.5	25.0	2.8	202603	10.2	29.4	12.1	15.1	5.1	9.5	4.4	37.59	8.9	
Aegis Logistics [1]	721.9	21.9	32.9	4.3	202512	1.1	42.3	7.9	33.1	3.0	14.5	0.9	946.5	576.0	
Aether Industri.	1213.9	16.9	72.0	6.9	202512	44.4	-62.7	52.7	33.2	3.5	9.7	0.1	1274.2	72.2	
Aegion Infrastr.	1213.9	16.9	72.0	6.9	202512	44.4	-62.7	52.7	33.2	3.5	9.7	0.1	1274.2	72.2	
Affle 31 [2]	1506.7	31.1	48.4	6.5	202512	19.2	19.1	19.2	19.7	5.6	16.6	0.1	2186.8	1251.5	
AIA Engineering [2]	3970.8	124.8	31.8	5.0	202512	-0.1	14.6	-2.6	10.3	0.6	19.1	0.2	400.0	300.6	
Ajanta Pharma [2]	3032.2	84.5	35.9	8.4	202603	21.5	18.4	21.3	14.7	7.3	32.0	0.0	3158.2	2335.0	
Akzo Pharma [2]	1965.8	35.5	26.5	2.5	202512	11.8	21.0	12.2	14.6	0.1	12.2	110.8	74.3	63.5	
Alkem Lab [2]	5576.8	200.9	77.8	5.0	202512	10.7	8.2	11.7	11.2	0.0	0.1	5933.0	4716.8		
Alkyl Amines [2]	1708.4	35.2	48.5	5.7	202603	0.2	-1.4	-2.3	-3.3	12.7	18.2	0.0	2448.8	1212.4	
Allied Blenders [2]	591.7	9.6	61.7	10.6	202512	3.0	19.5	14.0	135.6	11.1	21.0	0.9	720.0	367.3	
Allura Industries [1]	14.1	-1.1	-4.9	-0.3	202603	-0.2	-46.7	0.2	-14.9	2.2	0.1	1.2	23.5	11.1	
Amara Raja Ener. [1]	889.0	37.4	23.7	202512	4.2	-22.2	5.1	-26.8	1.7	15.6	0.0	109.9	107.5	61.0	
Amber Enterp.	8822.4	66.0	133.6	8.5	202512	37.9	26.4	30.7	4.6	9.9	13.5	8.8	8970.0	5404.0	
Amuja Cements [2]	444.3	20.0	22.2	1.9	202603	9.4	108.2	15.4	15.5	-0.1	12.7	0.0	625.0	394.0	
Anand Rathi Wea. [5]	3361.8	47.7	75.8	30.0	202512	20.0	34.7	40.5	22.3	32.1	0.4	56.8	0.1	373.9	403.0
Anant Raj [2]	560.9	14.6	38.7	3.7	202512	20.0	30.8	22.6	36.8	15.1	10.9	0.7	744.1	403.0	
Angel One [1]	326.1	10.0	32.5	4.9	202603	38.2	83.5	-1.9	-21.9	5.6	25.8	0.7	335.0	208.9	
Apur Inds.	12808.0	246.9	51.9	10.6	202512	16.3	29.8	20.8	22.8	3.9	32.6	0.1	12946.6	5810.0	
APL Apollo Tubes [2]	1948.8	43.3	45.0	10.2	202603	14.1	20.9	9.7	58.9	2.4	22.0	0.2	2300.9	1493.0	
Arcelor Hospitals [1]	8094.9	126.3	64.1	12.8	202512	17.2	38.8	14.5	28.6	6.0	17.5	0.6	8114.0	6680.0	
Apollo Tyres [1]	409.2	23.0	17.8	1.7	202512	11.8	43.4	6.2	8.3	0.2	10.9	0.3	540.3	392.3	
Apus Value Hou. [2]	282.8	18.8	15.0	2.8	202603	18.7	26.0	25.5	25.5	8.6	15.1	1.5	364.9	193.5	
Asahi India Glass [1]	836.1	12.3	68.0	5.8	202512	4.4	32.8	5.3	-4.7	0.0	13.1	0.9	1073.0	689.8	
Asahi Lloyds [2]	473.7	16.7	28.0	6.8	202603	3.2	7.0	4.6	-4.7	0.2	1.2	215.4	34.2	24.2	
Asian Paints [1]	2600.3	42.6	61.1	12.7	202512	3.9	5.7	1.3	-6.4	6.4	24.4	0.1	2985.5	2116.0	
Aster DM Health.	742.4	7.8	95.4	9.1	202603	18.2	39.7	12.2	17.6	5.8	11.6	0.5	770.0	518.2	
Astral [1]	1569.9	19.2	81.2	11.2	202512	10.3	5.2	6.7	-2.1	2.6	20.8	0.1	1786.0	1240.5	
Astrazeneca Phar [2]	817.4	81.9	102.0	12.2	202512	4.2	91.7	10.2	14.9	2.2	0.0	0.0181.04.0			
Ather Energy [1]	915.0	-13.4	13.6	202603	73.7	-142.8	62.8	36.9	-2.1	0.0	1.1	98.2	293.7		
Atul	7086.6	230.3	30.8	3.4	202603	15.0	66.1	12.4	40.1	4.1	12.8	0.0	7793.0	5563.0	
AU Small Finance	1050.4	35.3	29.8	4.0	202603	17.5	65.2	16.0	25.4	3.3	0.0	0.0	107.9	67.3	
Aurobindo Pharma	1458.5	68.8	24.5	2.5	202512	9.0	12.9	8.3	-0.7	-7.1	14.2	0.2	1514.0	1017.0	
Avenue Invest [1]	495.5	42.8	11.6	2.6	202512	-22.5	70.2	-16.0	-9.5	-4.9	29.7	0.1	683.5	335.2	
Avenue Super.	4404.4	45.5	96.7	11.7	202603	18.9	15.2	15.9	9.7	-4.1	18.0	0.0	4916.3	3528.7	
AWL Agril Busine. [1]	206.7	8.2	25.3	2.6	202603	17.7	53.5	17.3	-13.4	0.1	19.8	0.3	285.4	171.2	
Axis Bank [2]	1269.4	84.9	15.0	1.9	202603	5.3	1.7	4.1	-6.0	0.1	0.0	0.0	1418.3	1041.3	

BHEL [2]	404.7	4.6	88.0	5.4	202603	36.9	155.8	19.2	199.7	14.8	3.2	0.4	408.9	205.2
B P C L	302.9	57.6	5.3	1.4	202512	5.2	90.0	0.5	78.3	0.8	15.7	0.7	39.1	266.6
Bajaj Auto	10710.0	385.4	27.3	7.7	202603	40.2	101.6	22.6	47.1	7.1	28.1	0.2	10784.9	7556.1
Bajaj Finance [1]	955.1	30.8	31.0	5.2	202603	18.4	22.0	19.4	15.4	2.0	11.4	3.8	1120.5	788.4
Bajaj Finserv [1]	1816.4	62.9	28.9	3.7	202603	5.3	5.0	13.2	13.4	0.4	12.4	4.9	2194.7	1598.2
Bajaj Housing	3020.0	736.5	14.4	1.6	202603	-58.3	49.2	56.3	25.7	3.5	11.5	0.0	14873.2	8597.5
Bajaj Housing	87.6	3.1	38.4	3.2	202603	15.7	14.1	16.6	18.8	0.4	9.5	0.7	12.85	7.26
Balkrishna Inds [2]	2263.3	64.3	35.2	4.2	202603	6.6	-18.7	3.6	-24.9	4.8	17.9	0.3	2815.4	2050.8
Baltapuram Chini [1]	523.0	22.2	23.6	2.7	202512	22.0	61.0	15.4	9.0	0.5	11.1	0.6	627.0	393.4
Bandhan Bank [2]	264.1	7.6	27.1	1.3	202603	-0.1	68.0	-1.2	-55.4	3.1	0.0	0.0	21.26	134.3
Bank of Baroda [2]	204.1	38.4	6.9	0.8	202603	5.2	7.0	4.6	-4.2	0.2	2.0	0.0	32.6	21.2
Bank of India	139.8	23.5	6.0	0.8	202603	5.9	18.7	6.0	11.9	-0.1	0.0	0.0	17.85	104.1
Bank of Maha	83.8	9.1	9.2	2.1	202603	15.2	36.1	17.4	26.6	6.9	0.0	0.0	85.9	47.1
BASF India [1]	4035.9	84.3	47.9	4.6	202512	6.3	0.9	-1.9	-39.7	10.9	17.9	0.1	9418.2	2906.3
Bayer India [1]	809.4	14.9	56.3	20.2	202512	1.2	40.4	1.6	44.4	3.0	15.2	0.6	130.0	15.6
Bayer Crop Sci.	1469.8	149.2	30.9	6.6	202512	4.6	179.8	7.7	28.7	-3.4	23.8	0.0	6540.0	4276.9
BEML Ltd [1]	4049.1	29.9	65.2	5.8	202512	23.7	-191.7	8.4	-4.8	8.0	11.7	0.1	2437.4	1361.1
Berger Paints [1]	516.0	9.6	53.7	9.6	202512	0.3	5.1	3.1	-1.7	9.1	24.8	0.1	604.6	391.5
Birla Dynamics [1]	1591.0	38.5	19.5	12.6	202512	-31.4	-50.4	57.2	2.5	6.0	10.2	0.0	2096.0	1090.0
Bharat Electron [1]	439.7	8.2	53.9	14.9	202512	24.0	20.5	14.5	19.5	1.9	36.9	0.0	4733.3	304.5
Bharat Forge [2]	1988.5	24.6	80.9	9.9	202603	17.5	2.1	11.2	13.8	5.4	11.7	0.9	2043.9	1086.2
Bharat Heavy Electricals [1]	364.9	10.2	36.4	5.9	202603	1.2	58.0	1.2	58.0	1.2	58.0	1.2	58.0	1.2
Bharat Hexacom [5]	1498.2	35.2	42.5	12.0	202512	4.8	48.7	13.6	67.8	-1.1	16.5	1.5	2051.0	1438.6
Bikaji Foods [1]	671.8	10.0	67.5	11.2	202512	11.2	117.6	31.9	-8.3	-0.8	8.4	0.2	820.9	591.6
Blocon [5]	380.6	3.8	99.7	1.8	202603	2.9	-61.6	11.5	-35.4	5.8	6.9	0.8	42.5	317.9
Bombay Group [2]	593.9	74.2	13.4	1.3	202603	1.3	6.4	12.1	12.1	6.4	12.1	6.4	12.1	6.4
Birlsoft Ltd [2]	362.2	19.4	18.7	2.5	202603	2.4	-44.1	-1.2	-4.9	-1.9	20.8	0.0	473.8	320.0
BIS International [1]	289.4	15.6	18.5	5.6	202512	43.6	34.8	47.6	41.9	3.8	39.0	0.1	422.1	419.5
Blue Dart Express	5697.7	122.5	46.4	8.3	202512	6.3	30.1	7.1	5.7	4.0	17.1	0.7	722.4	298.0
Blue Bird Logistics [2]	405.0	10.2	36.4	5.9	202603	1.2	58.0	1.2	58.0	1.2	58.0	1.2	58.0	1.2
Blue Star [2]	169.24	27.0	62.7	10.1	202603	1.3	10.4	1.3	10.4	1.3	10.4	1.3	10.4	1.3
Bosch	3813.8	783.8	48.7	8.0	202512	9.4	7.9	11.3	14.2	5.9	20.5	0.0	41894.2	328650.1
Brainbees Solut. [2]	236.6	3.0	2.6	2.6	202512	11.6	-77.2	12.4	-3.4	-1.2	0.0	0.4	438.7	207.1
7999999999999999	7999999999999999	28.3	3.7	3.7	202512	11.6	-77.2	12.4	-3.4	-1.2	0.0	0.4	438.7	207.1
Britannia Inds [1]	5519.2	105.2	52.5	26.0	202603	7.1	21.1	7.5	15.3	-3.6	51.9	0.4	6337.0	5300.0



GETTY IMAGES

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl, Research Bureau

For many investors, the National Pension System (NPS) is first understood through its tax benefits, low-cost structure and retirement-planning role. But an NPS account also comes with an administrative layer. Central Recordkeeping Agencies, or CRAs, maintain subscriber records, process transactions and support account servicing. This comes at a cost.

PFRDA's latest clarification on CRA charges (<https://tiny-url.com/pfrdaapr29>) tells subscribers when these charges do/ don't apply and how they will be collected. The circular makes the cost structure more explicit, and that is useful for: a first-time subscriber, an existing subscriber with multiple accounts or schemes, and someone who has opened NPS, but has stopped contributing.

TIER II ACCOUNTS
The first important clarification concerns Tier II accounts. PFRDA has said the annual maintenance charge (AMC) for a Tier II account will be aligned with the AMC applicable to the Tier I account under the respective sector, both government and private.
In simple terms, Tier II will not sit outside the CRA charge framework because it is a voluntary account.

For a new subscriber, this is useful. Tier I is the retirement account with withdrawal restrictions and tax relevance. Tier II is more flexible, but is still part of the NPS architecture.

This clarification informs investors that Tier II is not cost-free by default. The possible downside is that someone who opens Tier II casually may end up paying maintenance charges if the balance is above the exempt threshold.

That threshold is the second important point. No AMC will be levied on a Tier II account with a corpus of up to ₹1,000 at the end of a quarter. This is a small but sensible protection. If a subscriber has a tiny Tier II balance, the account should not be gradually eroded by maintenance charges. The pro is obvious: small or inactive Tier II balances get some protection. This may help investors, who opened Tier II as an experiment or have left a very small sum in the account. The con is equally important. Once the quarter-end corpus is above ₹1,000, the exemption may not apply. So, subscribers should not assume that Tier II is free merely because the balance is small in absolute terms.

The third clarification is more consequential for existing subscribers. Each pension scheme maintained within a Permanent Retirement Account Number (PRAN) will be treated as a sep-

CHARGE WATCH

- Tier II AMC aligned with Tier I account
- Dormant accounts pay only 10 per cent of AMC
- Existing PRAN account activation remains free

arate account, whether under Tier I or Tier II, and each such account will attract AMC separately, as applicable. This is where investors must pay attention. Effective October 1, 2025, non-government NPS subscribers can hold and manage multiple pension schemes under a single PRAN.

It does not, however, necessarily mean a single AMC. The benefit of this rule is clarity. The cost treatment is now explicit. The drawback is that diversification within the NPS structure may carry separate administrative costs. This does not mean investors should avoid diversification. It means they should know the cost before spreading across multiple accounts or schemes.

DORMANT RELIEF

The fourth and most subscriber-friendly clarification concerns dormant accounts. If no contribution is received for four consecutive quarters, the account will be flagged as dormant in the first week of the next quarter in the CRA system. For such ac-

counts, the AMC will be only 10 per cent of the applicable AMC.

This matters for people who take career breaks, lose jobs, shift employment, become self-employed, move abroad temporarily or simply stop contributing. Charging the full maintenance fee during long inactivity can feel harsh, especially for small balances.

But there is a caveat. The account must receive no contribution for four consecutive quarters. The subscriber effectively waits through a full year of inactivity before the dormant status applies. Also, CRAs have to make the dormant/active flagging effective from July 1, 2026. Existing subscribers should therefore not assume that reduced AMC treatment applies immediately in every case.

The circular also states that once a contribution is received during a quarter, the account will be flagged active in the first week of the subsequent quarter. This creates a clean rule, but it also means subscribers should understand that the dormant-active status is system-driven and quarter-linked.

COST VISIBILITY

The fifth clarification concerns PRAN opening charges. PFRDA has said the PRAN opening charge will apply only at the time of initial PRAN generation. For activation or opening of each account, Tier I or Tier II, within an existing PRAN, the

charge will be nil.

For new subscribers, this means the initial PRAN generation is the relevant point for the opening charge. For existing subscribers, it removes doubt about whether adding or activating an account under the same PRAN involves another opening charge. This cuts friction for someone who wants to start Tier II later. But only opening or activation charge is nil; ongoing AMC rules still apply.

The sixth clarification concerns Atal Pension Yojana (APY) and NPS-Lite (lower-cost version) accounts, which are linked to small savers and lower-income subscribers. AMC for accounts with nil balance under APY and NPS-Lite will be nil. Zero-balance account will not face AMC. The limitation is that the circular specifically refers to nil-balance accounts; it should not be read as a blanket waiver for all low-balance accounts. Finally, charges will be collected at the end of each quarter. Where the employer bears CRA charges, the CRA will raise an invoice on the concerned entity. In other cases, charges may be collected through unit deduction from the subscriber's account. For long-term investors, low cost does not mean no cost. NPS remains a cost-efficient retirement product, but subscribers should still track A/C statements, understand deductions & avoid opening accounts/ schemes without purpose.

SIMPLYPUT.

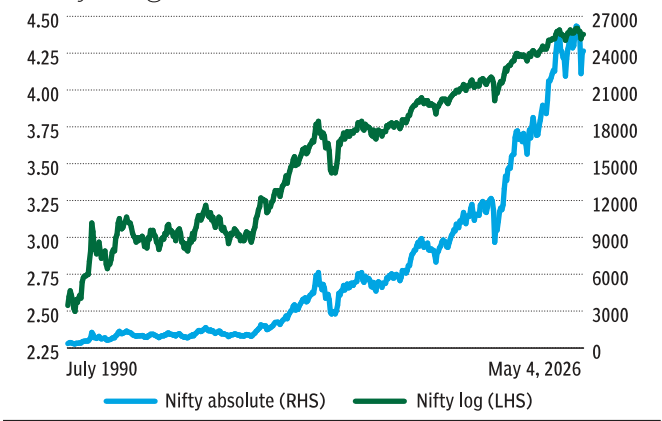
Logging the absolute chart

Gurumurthy K
bl, research bureau

Mark noticed Antony sitting beside him at work, looking a little lost and seemingly contemplating something.
Mark: Hey Antony. What are you thinking about?
Antony: A couple of weeks back, I saw the log chart analysis of the BSE Information Technology index in bl.portfolio. I was surprised to see that the log chart of the BSE IT index was giving a completely different picture.
Mark: How does that make you clueless now?
Antony: After reading that analysis, I was trying to do self-study about log charts. But I am not able to understand the concept.
Mark: Come on. Take that paper and scale from your desk and let us go to the canteen and discuss this over coffee.
(Antony waits at a table while Mark brings them their coffee)
Mark: Here is your coffee, Antony.
Antony: Thanks Mark. Now, explain to me about the log chart.
Mark: In a chart, we can plot the values in different forms. One is plotting the values (10,20,30 etc) as it is in the Y-axis of the graph. Since we are plotting the absolute values as it is, the Y-axis here can be called absolute scale.
Antony: Yes, I know. That is

the usual chart which is widely used in every case. But how do I get a log chart
Mark: Yes, my dear friend, I am coming to that part next. In a log chart, we convert the absolute values into a log value and plot them. You must have studied logarithms in school.
Antony: Yes, I vaguely remember that.
Mark: If you can recollect, log 1 to the base of 10 is zero and log 10 to the base of 10 is 1.
Antony: oh..oh..oh... Please stop. Don't go back to maths. If you can explain it in simple terms, then we can continue. Else, I will get back to work.
Mark: Okay. Take your paper and scale. Draw two lines. One below the other. First from 5 cm to 10 cm. The second from 15 cm to 30 cm. Tell me the size of both lines and how do they look
Antony: hmm, the first line is 5 cm length and is smaller than the second line which is 15 cm long.
Mark: Now, note down the log values of these numbers. 0.7 (log of 5), 1 (log of 10), 1.18 (log of 15) and 1.48 (log of 30).
Antony: Yes noted. But how and where can I get these values?
Mark: In Excel, you have a function called log. You can get it by typing the formula: log(5).
Antony: Oh, that's cool.
Mark: Now draw another two sets of lines, one below the other using these log values. From 0.7 cm to 1 cm and 1.18

Nifty: Log vs absolute chart



cm to 1.48 cm.

Antony: Let me try.
Mark: Yes, tell me your observation.
Antony: Oh no. What is this. Both the lines are of the same size, 0.30 cm. How come?
Mark: You will get the logic right if you answer this question correctly. In our example 5,10 and 15,30, the second number in both sets are twice that of the first number.
Antony: hmmm, yeah. 10 is two times of 5 (5*2) and 30 is two times of 15 (15*2).
Mark: Now, think of these numbers in terms of share price movement of say stock A and stock B. You bought A at ₹5 and sold it at ₹10. Similarly, you purchased B at ₹15 and sold it at ₹30. What is your profit?
Antony: From A, I got profit

of ₹5 (₹10-5) and from B ₹15 (₹30-15).
Mark: What is your return in terms of percentage.
Antony: My investment doubled in both cases. So, it is a 100 per cent return for both.
Mark: Yes, that is the logic of a log chart.
Antony: As in?
Mark: A log chart will capture the percentage movement between two points rather than their absolute values.
Antony: Oh, that is the reason the length of the two lines drawn by taking the log values (of 5,10 and 15,30) are the same than the ones drawn using the absolute values.
Mark: Exactly.
Antony: What is the use or purpose of using a log chart in

financial markets?
Mark: You remember the market movement in 2008-2009 (the great financial crisis), 2020 (Covid) etc.
Antony: Yeah, highly volatile times for the markets.
Mark: Correct. Log values will normalise this volatility and give you a smooth curve on the chart. Whereas, using absolute values can show you some wild swings on the graph.
When you analyze a very long historical price movement, say for 30 years or so, log chart will give you a much better picture.
Antony: How come?
Mark: Assume that the share price has gone from ₹2 to ₹5,000 in 30 years. The price graph will look different in an absolute price chart and a log chart.
Antony: Movement from ₹2 to ₹5,000, hmmm.
Mark: Don't think too much now. You will get more confused.
Antony: Yeah, I am not able to visualise that.
Mark: Come on. Let's go back to our desk. Take a list of 10 stocks. Look at the price graph of all of them in both absolute price scale and log scale. You can understand much better. A picture is worth a thousand words.
Antony: Yes, I will do that.
Mark: In our next coffee break I will tell you how to use the log chart for analysis, what are the advantages etc.
To be continued...

Bank FD interest rates (%)

Bank	<1 year	1 to 2 years	2 to 3 years	3 to 5 years	w.e.f
FOREIGN BANKS					
DBS Bank	6	6.85	6.4	6.4	May 06
Deutsche Bank	5	7	6.25	6.25	Jul 25
HSBC	4.1	5.5	5.35	5.5	Jul 17
Standard Chartered	5.75	6.6	6.5	6.5	Aug 29
INDIAN: PUBLIC SECTOR BANKS					
Bank of Maharashtra	5.25	6.65	5.25	5.25	Apr 23
Bank of Baroda	6	6.6	6.5	6.4	Jun 12
Bank of India	5.5	6.6	6.3	6.25	Mar 02
Canara Bank	5.5	6.6	6.25	6.25	Mar 17
Central Bank of India	5	6.2	6.25	6	Dec 10
Indian Bank	4.75	6.6	6.15	6.05	Mar 03
Indian Overseas Bank	5.5	6.6	6.4	6.1	Dec 15
Punjab National Bank	5.6	6.6	6.3	6.1	Feb 24
Punjab & Sind Bank	4.85	6.75	6	5.95	Feb 16
State Bank of India	5.9	6.45	6.4	6.3	Dec 15
UCO Bank	5	6.45	6.1	6	Apr 01
Union Bank	5.9	6.6	6.2	6	Apr 20
INDIAN: PRIVATE SECTOR BANKS					
Axis Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.45	May 08
Bandhan Bank	4.20	7	7.25	7.25	Mar 25
CSB Bank	6.75	7.35	6.5	5.75	Apr 06
City Union Bank	6.25	7	6.5	6.25	May 05
DCB Bank	6.5	7.25	7.25	7.25	May 02
Dhanlaxmi Bank	5.25	6.95	6.25	7	Mar 26
Federal Bank	6	6.7	6.75	6.4	Mar 12
HDFC Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.5	Mar 06
ICICI Bank	5.5	6.3	6.45	6.5	May 08
IDBI Bank	5.8	6.45	6.5	6.35	Feb 23
IDFC First Bank	6.5	7.25	7.25	7.15	Apr 18
IndusInd Bank	6.25	7	6.9	6.65	Sep 25
J & K Bank	6	6.75	7.25	6.65	Feb 11
Karnataka Bank	5.75	6.75	6.15	6.15	Apr 11
Kotak Bank	6	6.8	6.8	6.4	May 06
Karur Vysya Bank	6.65	7.2	6.55	6.55	Apr 06
RBL Bank	6.05	7.2	7.2	7	Sep 24
South Indian Bank	5.9	6.8	6.2	6.2	Apr 09
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	6.5	7.25	7	6.7	Apr 10
TNSC Bank	6.85	7.6	7.1	6.85	NA
Yes Bank	6.5	7	7	7	Mar 05
SMALL FINANCE BANKS					
Equitas Small Finance Bank	6.35	6.9	7.4	7	Mar 02
ESAF Small Finance Bank	4.75	7.75	7.75	6	May 01
Jana Small Finance Bank	7	7.5	7.5	7.77	Apr 11
Suryoday Small Finance Bank	6.5	7.6	8.1	7.9	29-Mar
Utkarsh Small Finance Bank	6	8.1	7.5	7.25	May 05
Ujjivan Small Finance Bank	6	7.45	7.25	7.2	05-Aug

Data as on respective banks' website on 08 May 2026; For each year range, the maximum offered interest rate is considered; Interest rate is for a normal fixed deposit amount below ₹1 crore. Compiled by BankBazaar.com;

How sectoral indices moved

	Apr 30	May 8	Movement	% change
AUTO	57,171.0	59,963.4	▲	4.9
REALTY	6,127.7	6,410.4	▲	4.6
HEALTHCARE	44,614.8	46,534.9	▲	4.3
CAPITAL GOODS	77,210.2	80,125.2	▲	3.8
CONSUMER DURABLES	59,099.5	60,554.3	▲	2.5
POWER	8,156.3	8,284.9	▲	1.6
METALS	42,195.3	42,743.6	▲	1.3
BANKEX	61,706.9	62,353.8	▲	1.0
IT	28,406.8	28,584.7	▲	0.6
FMCG	18,890.8	18,997.7	▲	0.6
PSU	21,879.2	21,838.3	▼	-0.2
TECK	15,023.5	14,937.3	▼	-0.6
OIL&GAS	27,683.5	27,413.9	▼	-1.0

How other indices moved

NIFTY NEXT 50	69,643.9	71,495.6	▲	2.7
NIFTY 500	22,683.6	23,115.7	▲	1.9
NIFTY 200	13,705.6	13,920.8	▲	1.6
NIFTY 100	24,896.0	25,168.6	▲	1.1
BANK NIFTY	54,863.4	55,310.6	▲	0.8

ALERTS.

NPS Sanchay launched

The Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA) has introduced 'NPS Sanchay', a simplified National Pension System variant designed for India's informal workforce. Unveiled on May 6, it simplifies investment choices and asset allocation, removing technical hurdles for last-mile subscribers. Eligibility extends to all Indian citizens aged 18 to 85.

the hindu

businessline.

Classifieds

TENDERS

HOMCO KERALA

Invites E-Tenders for the following
Tenders
a, Plastic Caps & Plugs
b, Impalpable Lactose Monohydrate
IP/BP/(USB-NF) with (HMS/HPI)
c, PVC Rigid Film
d, Corrugated master cartons
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Term insurance premium tracker

For a 30-year-old male/female, non smoker, living in a metro city, Sum assured ₹1 crore with coverage up to 70 yrs

Insurance company	Plan name	Max coverage up to	Max policy term	Annual premium		Claim settlement ratio (%)
		(years)	(years)	Male	Female	
Aditya Birla Capital	Super Term Plan	85	55	11,167	9,203	98.4
Bajaj Life	eTouch II	85	55	10,714	8,832	99.3
Canara HSBC Life	Young Term Plan - Life Secure	99	69	11,345	9,477	99.2
HDFC Life	Click 2 Protect Super	85	55	12,390	10,531	99.7
ICICI Prudential	iProtect Smart	99	69	14,462	9,645	99.3
Axis Max Life	Smart Term Plan Plus	85	55	11,217	9,527	99.7
SBI Life	Smart Shield Plus	79	49	13,206	11,109	99.4
TATA AIA Life	Sampoorna Raksha Promise	100	70	11,111	9,429	99.4
Bandhan Life	iTerm Prime	70	40	11,466	9,963	99.7

Claim settlement ratio as per data provided by insurer
Source: www.policybazaar.com, Date: May 08, 2026

Health insurance premium tracker

For a 30-year-old male, non-smoker, sum insured of ₹10 lakh living in a metro city

Insurer	Plan name	Key features	Premium (₹)
ICICI Lombard	Elevate	OPD rider with no sub-limits. Single pvt AC Room. ₹2 lakh NCB. Unlimited Restoration of cover.	7,792
Care	Care Supreme	Guaranteed 7x increase over 5 years with rider. No Room Rent Limit. ₹15 lakh Renewal Bonus; optional Unlimited Restoration of cover.	10,838
Niva Bupa Health	Health ReAssure	Unlimited claims up to the cover amount. No Room Rent Limit. ₹5 lakh NCB. Unlimited Restoration of cover.	12,033
Star Health	Super Star	Fully loaded plan with one-time unlimited claim. Unlimited bonus. Lock the age till 50. No Room Rent Limit. ₹5 lakh NCB.	8,173
Aditya Birla Health	Activ One Max	100% issuance offer guarantee. No Room Rent Limit. ₹10 lakh Renewal Bonus; optional Unlimited Restoration of cover	8,828
Tata AIG	Medicare Select	Special discount for young families and salaried customers. Single pvt AC Room. ₹5 lakh NCB. Unlimited Restoration of cover.	7,474
Reliance General	My HealthCare	Additional 30% discount on premium & fully customisable plan. Single pvt AC Room. ₹3.33 lakh NCB. Restoration of cover once a year.	7,326

Date: May 08, 2025. Source: www.policybazaar.com. NCB: No Claim Bonus

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bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	

EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS

*****	Canara Robeco Large Cap	60.8	15235	1.7	0.6	0.3	12.4	11.4	13.9	0.35
*****	ICICI Pru Large Cap	108.0	69948	1.4	0.9	2.0	15.2	14.6	14.5	0.50
*****	Nippon Ind Large Cap	89.5	46521	1.5	0.7	4.8	15.8	16.8	15.1	0.56
*****	HDFC Large Cap	1109.1	35458	1.6	1.0	0.6	12.8	13.8	13.5	0.45
*****	JM Large Cap	150.9	422	2.4	0.9	4.9	13.6	12.5	11.5	0.36
*****	Kotak Large Cap	559.1	9794	1.7	0.7	2.2	12.9	12.2	12.9	0.37
*****	SBI Large Cap	92.7	53468	1.5	0.8	4.8	12.1	12.4	12.5	0.39
***	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	511.1	28970	1.6	1.0	1.3	13.0	12.4	12.5	0.38
***	Bandhan Large Cap	76.8	1821	2.1	0.9	5.6	14.9	13.0	13.2	0.38
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	219.6	2344	2.0	0.8	4.1	14.2	13.0	12.9	0.40
***	Edelweiss Large Cap	82.1	1322	2.1	0.6	1.7	12.3	12.1	13.0	0.37
***	Franklin Ind Large Cap	995.5	7236	1.9	1.2	1.5	12.2	10.2	11.2	0.32
***	Invesco India Largecap	69.0	1537	2.0	0.7	5.0	15.9	13.9	13.1	0.41
***	Mirae Asset Large Cap	109.8	35343	1.5	0.6	2.4	11.0	10.7	13.3	0.32
***	Tata Large Cap	500.7	2688	2.0	1.0	4.2	13.2	12.4	12.4	0.39
***	UTI Large Cap	261.9	12053	1.9	1.2	-0.8	10.6	9.9	11.9	0.28
***	DSP Large Cap	456.4	6620	1.8	0.9	-1.0	14.9	12.2	11.8	0.39
***	HSBC Large Cap	466.9	1784	2.2	1.3	3.4	12.9	11.6	12.6	0.33
***	LIC MF Large Cap	52.9	1352	2.2	1.1	-1.2	9.5	9.1	10.7	0.25
***	Union Largecap	23.0	439	2.6	1.8	2.3	11.0	10.8	-	0.32
***	Axis Large Cap	58.2	28661	1.6	0.7	-0.4	10.1	8.2	12.1	0.21
*	Groww Largecap	42.4	117	2.5	1.3	5.6	12.3	11.2	11.4	0.31
*	PGIM India Large Cap	327.3	544	2.4	0.9	-0.2	9.0	8.5	10.6	0.24
*	Mahi Manu Large Cap	22.0	701	2.4	0.8	-1.6	11.7	10.3	-	0.32
-	Taurus Large Cap	157.2	51	2.6	2.3	5.0	14.4	11.9	10.8	0.34

EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS

*****	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	140.5	14109	1.7	0.5	13.6	23.5	19.3	16.6	0.59
*****	HDFC Large and Mid Cap	340.1	25295	1.6	0.9	7.9	18.3	17.9	15.4	0.54
*****	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	1019.7	27005	1.6	0.8	7.5	19.6	19.2	16.3	0.67
*****	Axis Large & Mid Cap	33.6	13973	1.7	0.6	9.8	18.5	14.9	-	0.41
*****	Quant Large & Mid Cap	120.1	3249	2.0	0.7	9.0	17.9	16.5	16.3	0.45
*****	SBI Large & Midcap	638.9	38426	1.6	0.7	10.6	16.5	16.5	15.4	0.55
*****	UTI Large & Mid Cap	183.9	5896	1.9	1.0	9.7	20.5	17.4	14.8	0.57
*****	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	91.2	468	2.3	1.1	12.8	16.5	14.8	13.3	0.44
***	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	249.5	22203	1.6	0.7	4.4	15.1	13.8	15.6	0.40
***	DSP Large & Mid Cap	613.7	15070	1.7	0.7	4.2	18.5	14.8	15.5	0.47
***	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	89.1	4067	1.5	0.5	11.1	17.9	15.5	15.3	0.46
***	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	102.5	8436	1.8	0.6	14.2	24.2	18.6	16.6	0.48
***	Kotak Large & Midcap	347.2	27373	1.6	0.6	10.3	17.4	16.0	15.9	0.48
***	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	152.9	38138	1.5	0.6	10.6	16.2	13.5	17.4	0.40
***	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1478.4	6299	1.9	1.1	7.5	19.6	16.9	13.7	0.51
***	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	186.9	3399	2.1	1.4	5.1	15.3	13.2	12.0	0.40
***	LIC MF Large & Midcap	38.0	2958	2.0	0.9	5.5	17.0	14.1	14.7	0.41
***	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	86.1	6031	1.8	0.7	7.7	15.6	14.6	14.8	0.41
***	Tata Large & Mid Cap	491.6	7802	1.8	0.7	-1.0	10.5	12.0	13.0	0.34
*	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	921.8	5648	1.9	1.1	9.7	14.8	10.8	12.3	0.25
*	Navi Large & Midcap	35.7	267	2.3	0.5	7.9	12.4	12.6	13.1	0.35
-	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	28.5	4877	1.9	0.8	17.1	20.6	16.7	-	0.40

EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS

*****	HDFC Flexi Cap	1968.6	91335	1.4	0.7	3.5	18.8	19.2	16.7	0.69
*****	JM Flexicap	95.7	5041	1.9	0.7	3.2	18.9	17.6	16.9	0.50
*****	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	83.6	128966	1.3	0.6	3.5	16.8	15.6	17.4	0.59
*****	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	38.7	2957	1.9	0.5	8.0	17.5	15.3	15.3	0.45
*****	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1581.0	19049	1.7	0.9	0.6	16.1	15.1	13.8	0.47
*****	PGIM India Flexi Cap	35.8	5793	1.8	0.5	4.7	11.8	10.7	14.3	0.30
*****	Union Flexi Cap	50.6	2294	2.1	1.0	5.3	14.1	13.2	13.6	0.38
***	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1868.4	25632	1.7	0.9	10.1	17.8	13.8	14.7	0.41
***	Bandhan Flexi Cap	207.4	6651	1.9	1.2	5.2	14.9	12.9	11.4	0.38
***	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	335.7	11922	1.7	0.6	5.5	13.6	12.5	14.6	0.38
***	DSP Flexi Cap	100.6	10726	1.7	0.7	3.3	14.9	12.4	14.6	0.35
***	HSBC Flexi Cap	224.8	5405	2.0	1.2	11.3	18.9	15.9	13.8	0.42
***	Kotak Flexicap	84.9	50146	1.4	0.6	7.0	15.0	13.4	14.2	0.39
***	SBI Flexicap	107.0	22403	1.7	0.9	2.8	11.0	10.8	12.4	0.33
***	Tata Flexi Cap	23.7	3633	1.9	0.6	2.9	14.8	12.2	-	0.36
**	Axis Flexi Cap	26.5	11413	1.7	0.7	6.1	14.2	11.0	-	0.29
**	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	57.7	11679	1.7	0.8	-0.1	20.3	12.8	12.8	0.33
**	Navi Flexi Cap	23.9	232	2.2	0.5	14.1	13.3	12.4	-	0.36
**	UTI Flexi Cap	301.8	22168	1.6	1.0	-2.3	9.2	7.3	12.0	0.15
**	LIC MF Flexi Cap	98.1	973	2.4	1.7	12.6	13.0	11.4	10.6	0.29
*	Shriram Flexi Cap	19.6	128	2.4	0.5	2.6	9.5	9.3	-	0.22
*	Taurus Flexi Cap	222.8	344	2.7	2.6	4.6	13.6	11.6	10.4	0.32
-	Quant Flexi Cap	104.4	6594	2.0	0.8	12.2	18.3	17.8	19.7	0.50

EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS

-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	292.1	2861	2.0	0.9	10.1	18.3	16.8	15.1	0.45
-	ICICI Pru Multicap	842.5	14681	1.8	1.0	12.6	20.9	18.3	15.6	0.58
-	Invesco India Multicap	124.9	3550	1.9	0.7	2.2	15.9	14.3	13.9	0.38
-	Mahi Manu Multi Cap	37.1	6439	1.8	0.5	14.1	21.1	18.0	-	0.50
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	302.5	46321	1.5	0.7	10.5	20.4	21.5	16.4	0.66
-	Quant Multi Cap	640.5	7466	1.9	0.7	9.0	13.2	13.1	17.6	0.35
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	376.1	2525	2.0	0.9	6.9	16.1	15.5	15.2	0.45

EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS

*****	Edelweiss Mid Cap	106.7	13554	1.7	0.5	16.1	25.6	21.5	19.2	0.59
*****	HDFC Mid Cap	202.3	85358	1.4	0.8	14.7	23.9	21.7	18.5	0.67
*****	Quant Mid Cap	216.3	7905	1.8	0.9	4.7	17.1	17.8	17.0	0.50
*****	Invesco India Midcap	187.7	9895	1.7	0.6	20.1	26.8	21.9	18.9	0.56
*****	Mahi Manu Mid Cap	35.8	4688	1.9	0.5	16.2	25.3	20.2	-	0.57
*****	Motilal Oswal Midcap	94.3	31047	1.6	0.9	-1.2	21.8	23.6	17.0	0.59
*****	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	4442.4	39676	1.6	0.8	17.6	25.9	22.6	19.5	0.64
***	Axis Midcap	117.7	28835	1.6	0.5	14.2	19.7	16.1	17.2	0.45
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	110.4	2129	2.0	0.5	18.8	22.0	18.4	16.3	0.52
***	ICICI Pru Midcap	338.9	6569	1.9	1.1	28.3	26.7	20.9	17.7	0.61
***	Kotak Midcap	141.9	55676	1.4	0.4	18.2	22.3	19.2	18.2	0.54
***	PGIM India Midcap	64.3	10738	1.7	0.5	8.5	14.1	14.2	16.2	0.41
***	SBI Midcap	240.8	23247	1.7	0.9	8.1	16.1	16.9	14.6	0.50
***	Sundaram Mid Cap	1467.7	11898	1.7	0.9	16.9	24.9	20.6	15.7	0.57
***	Tata Mid Cap	455.4	5604	1.9	0.7	15.7	21.6	17.8	16.8	0.51
**	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	826.0	6290	1.9	1.0	14.4	21.1	18.0	14.5	0.49
**	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2741.9	12102	1.8	1.0	7.4	20.9	16.8	15.1	0.45
**	Taurus Mid Cap	120.3	123	2.6	2.2	8.9	15.6	13.7	15.4	0.35
**	UTI Mid Cap	305.4	11680	2.1	1.3	11.7	17.2	15.6	14.6	0.41
**	DSP Midcap	151.9	17492	1.7	0.7	13.9	20.3	14.3	15.4	0.38
**	HSBC Midcap	439.4	13387	1.7	0.7	26.4	27.7	19.8	17.9	0.48
*	LIC MF Midcap	29.8	347	2.5	1.4	11.9	20.6	15.7	-	0.39

EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS

*****	Nippon Ind Small Cap	176.0	61809	1.4	0.7	15.2	21.6	22.6	21.4	0.58
*****	Quant Small Cap	267.1	30374	1.7	0.8	13.5	21.3	21.1	19.4	0.52
*****	AXIS Small Cap	109.3	23919	1.6	0.6	13.2	18.6	18.4	18.5	0.54

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	

★★★★	Bank of India Small Cap	50.8	2168	2.0	0.5	21.6	22.9	20.4	-	0.48
★★★★	Invesco India Smallcap	43.7	9208	1.7	0.5	17.7	25.2	22.6	-	0.55
★★★★	DSP Small Cap	208.8	15300	1.7	0.8	22.5	21.6	20.0	17.0	0.51
★★★★	HDFC Small Cap	137.1	33724	1.6	0.8	12.5	17.2	19.4	18.1	0.51
★★★★	ICICI Pru Smallcap	87.1	7538	1.8	0.8	11.2	16.3	18.1	16.5	0.55
★★★★	Kotak Small Cap	259.0	15157	1.7	0.6	9.7	16.0	15.8	17.1	0.41
★★★★	Sundaram Small Cap	279.7	2983	2.0	0.9	20.9	21.4	19.7	15.3	0.49
★★★★	Tata Small Cap	36.4	11330	1.7	0.4	1.9	13.8	17.4	-	0.45
★★★★	Union Small Cap	54.9	1980	2.2	1.1	28.5	22.4	19.5	16.9	0.46
★★★	Franklin Ind Small Cap	175.4	13850	1.8	1.0	10.9	19.6	20.3	15.9	0.50
★★★	HSBC Small Cap	83.7	16394	1.7	0.8	14.3	18.2	20.4	19.1	0.47
★★	SBI Small Cap	170.9	37141	1.6	0.8	7.8	14.1	15.3	18.0	0.44
★	Aditya Birla SL Small Cap	92.1	5253	1.9	0.9	19.6	19.7	15.4	13.8	0.37
★	LIC MF Small Cap	32.4	660	2.4	1.1	18.9	20.5	19.7	-	0.46
-	Canara Robeco Small Cap	39.7	11603	1.7	0.6	13.2	17.0	18.8	-	0.51
-	Delaware Small Cap	45.5	5108	1.8	0.5	15.0	19.8	19.7	-	0.53

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Month %Ann	3 Month %Ann	6 Month %Ann	1 Year CAGR	

CASH FUNDS

LIQUID FUNDS

- 360 ONE Liquid	2112.5	1048	0.3	0.2	5.7	6.5	6.1	6.0	-
- Aditya Birla SL Liquid	442.8	56604	0.4	0.2	5.9	6.7	6.3	6.2	-
- Axis Liquid	3060.7	51643	0.2	0.1	5.9	6.8	6.4	6.3	-
- Bandhan Liquid	3317.1	17385	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.6	6.2	6.1	-
- Bank of India Liquid	3165.4	1735	0.1	0.1	5.9	6.6	6.3	6.3	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid	3157.7	11412	0.3	0.1	5.9	6.6	6.2	6.1	-
- Canara Robeco Liquid	3307.6	6395	0.2	0.1	5.9	6.8	6.3	6.2	-
- DSP Liquidity	3923.8	22480	0.2	0.1	5.9	6.7	6.3	6.2	-
- Edelweiss Liquid	3514.9	15091	0.1	0.0	6.0	6.7	6.3	6.3	-
- Groww Liquid	2657.0	278	0.2	0.1	5.7	6.6	6.3	6.2	-
- HDFC Liquid	5390.8	72873	0.3	0.2	5.8	6.7	6.3	6.2	-
- HSBC Liquid	2738.9	17559	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.6	6.2	6.2	-
- ICICI Pru Liquid	406.6	54639	0.3	0.2	5.8	6.6	6.2	6.2	-
- Invesco India Liquid	3776.7	16549	0.2	0.2	5.9	6.7	6.3	6.2	-
- ITI Liquid	1429.2	55	0.3	0.1	5.8	6.3	6.0	6.1	-
- JM Liquid	74.9	2835	0.3	0.2	5.8	6.5	6.1	6.1	-
- Kotak Liquid	5551.7	42389	0.3	0.2	5.8	6.6	6.2	6.2	-
- LIC MF Liquid	4966.2	15638	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.7	6.3	6.2	-
- Mahi Manu Liquid	1787.9	1059	0.3	0.2	5.9	6.6	6.3	6.2	-
- Mirae Asset Liquid	2880.2	13590	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.6	6.2	6.2	-
- Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.5	974	0.4	0.2	5.2	6.1	5.8	5.8	-
- Navi Liquid	29.8	76	0.2	0.2	5.1	5.7	5.6	5.7	-
- Nippon Ind Liquid	6704.8	37903	0.4	0.2	5.8	6.7	6.3	6.2	-
- Parag Parikh Liquid	1523.3	5260	0.2	0.1	5.9	6.7	6.2	6.1	-
- PGIM India Liquid	357.7	584	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.7	6.3	6.2	4.30
- Quant Liquid	43.3	1266	0.6	0.3	5.0	5.7	5.7	5.8	-
- Quantum Liquid	36.7	529	0.3	0.2	5.2	5.8	5.7	5.7	-
- SBI Liquid	4292.9	74571	0.3	0.2	5.8	6.6	6.2	6.2	-
- Sundaram Liquid	2421.0	7086	0.4	0.1	5.8	6.5	6.1	6.1	-
- Tata Liquid	4327.2	27400	0.3	0.2	5.9	6.6	6.3	6.2	-
- Union Liquid	2644.1	8163	0.2	0.1	6.0	6.6	6.3	6.2	-
- UTI Liquid	4508.4	31184	0.3	0.2	5.8	6.7	6.3	6.2	-
- WhiteOak Capital Liquid	1476.5	568	0.3	0.2	5.7	6.6	6.2	6.1	-

OVERNIGHT FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Overnight	1451.8	6108	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Axis Overnight	1427.9	11376	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.2	5.4	-
- Bandhan Overnight	1432.7	632	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Bank of India Overnight	1371.0	43	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.1	5.2	5.5	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Overnight	1415.5	867	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Canara Robeco Overnight	1396.1	296	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- DSP Overnight	1441.9	2116	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Edelweiss Overnight	1395.3	208	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Franklin Ind Overnight	1407.6	949	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.2	5.4	-
- Groww Overnight	1386.0	83	0.2	0.1	4.8	4.9	5.0	5.2	-
- HDFC Overnight	3972.1	9431	0.2	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- HSBC Overnight	1405.0	4223	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- ICICI Pru Overnight	1450.0	11369	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Invesco India Overnight	1363.1	337	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- ITI Overnight	1361.1	16	0.2	0.1	4.7	4.7	4.8	5.1	-
- JM Overnight	1366.0	89	0.2	0.1	4.7	4.8	4.9	5.2	-
- Kotak Overnight	1435.0	7487	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- LIC MF Overnight	1391.9	530	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Mahi Manu Overnight	1391.9	128	0.2	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Mirae Asset Overnight	1380.3	1389	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Nippon Ind Overnight	144.5	6199	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- PGIM India Overnight	1389.6	44	0.2	0.2	4.8	4.9	5.0	5.3	-
- SBI Overnight	4343.2	27043	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Sundaram Overnight	1428.1	624	0.2	0.1	5.0	4.9	5.0	5.3	-
- Tata Overnight	1417.9	4376	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Union Overnight	1415.3	411	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- UTI Overnight	3664.9	5730	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-

ARBITRAGE FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	27.9	25679	1.0	0.3	5.3	5.3	5.9	5.8	-
- Axis Arbitrage	19.6	9023	1.0	0.3	5.7	5.4	6.0	5.8	-
- Bandhan Arbitrage	34.0	7790	1.1	0.3	5.7	5.3	5.7	5.5	-
- Bank of India Arbitrage	14.5	45	0.9	0.4	6.3	5.5	5.9	5.5	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	16.8	1276	1.1	0.3	5.4	5.1	5.5	5.5	-
- DSP Arbitrage	15.7	6376	0.9	0.3	5.5	5.3	5.9	5.6	-
- Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.3	14414	1.1	0.4	5.4	5.5	5.9	5.7	-
- HDFC Arbitrage	32.2	23777	0.9	0.4	5.5	5.3	6.1	5.8	-
- HSBC Arbitrage	19.9	2532	0.9	0.3	5.6	5.9	6.1	5.8	-
- ICICI Pru Equity-Arbitrage	36.0	31342	0.9	0.4	5.8	5.7	6.1	5.9	-
- Invesco India Arbitrage	33.5	26370	1.1	0.4	5.8	5.3	6.1	5.9	-
- ITI Arbitrage	13.6	73	0.9	0.2	5.0	5.8	6.1	5.8	-
- JM Arbitrage	34.1	367	1.1	0.4	5.6	5.1	5.7	5.4	-
- Kotak Arbitrage	39.4	67117	1.0	0.4	5.7	5.6	6.1	5.8	-
- LIC MF Arbitrage	14.5	244	1.0	0.3	6.1	5.6	6.0	5.6	-
- Mahi Manu Arbitrage	12.9	112	1.1	0.4	4.9	4.7	5.6	5.1	-
- Mirae Asset Arbitrage	13.7	3474	0.9	0.1	5.4	5.0	5.7	5.6	-
- Nippon Ind Arbitrage	27.9	15788	1.0	0.3	5.7	5.4	5.9	5.7	0.80
- PGIM India Arbitrage	19.2	97	1.0	0.4	5.2	5.3	5.8	5.3	-
- SBI Arbitrage Opport	35.5	42847	0.9	0.4	5.9	5.5	6.1	5.9	-
- Sundaram Arbitrage	15.2	412	1.0	0.3	5.7	5.5	6.2	5.7	-
- Tata Arbitrage	15.1	21824	1.1	0.3	5.7	5.5	6.1	5.8	-
- Union Arbitrage	14.7	239	1.0	0.4	5.2	5.3	5.7	5.5	-
- UTI Arbitrage	36.8	10858	2.4	1.8	5.8	5.5	6.1	5.9	-

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	

DEBT FUNDS

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT DURATION FUNDS

★★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Savings	577.5	19985	0.6	0.3	6.5	7.2	7.3	6.3	10.83
★★★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Ultra Short Dur	1623.2	651	0.5	0.3	6.3	7.0	7.1	6.2	-
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Ultra Short Duration	4235.2	11083	1.1	0.4	6.2	6.7	6.8	6.7	18.83
★★★★★	Bandhan Ultra Short Duration	16.0	4458	0.5	0.3	6.2	6.9	7.0	6.0	-
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	29.2	15929	0.8	0.4	6.4	6.9	7.0	6.1	8.82
★★★★★	Mirae Asset Ultra Short Duration	1377.6	1420	0.4	0.1	6.4	7.1	7.2	6.2	1.41
★★★★★	UTI Ultra Short Duration	4446.1	4126	1.0	0.4	5.9	6.6	6.7	6.3	7.74
★★★★	Axis Ultra Short Duration	15.5	5916	1.2	0.4	5.9	6.5	6.6	5.6	8.36
★★★★	DSP Ultra Short	3572.2	4167	1.0	0.3	5.9	6.6	6.7	5.6	7.24
★★★★	HDFC Ultra Short Term	15.9	16753	0.7	0.4	6.1	6.8	6.9	6.0	4.41
★★★★	HSBC Ultra Short Duration	1424.9	3118	0.3	0.2	6.3	6.9	7.0	6.1	-
★★★★	Invesco India Ultra Short Duration	2833.4	1073	0.8	0.2	6.1	6.7	6.9	5.8	9.14
★★★★	Kotak Savings	45.0	16824	0.8	0.4	6.1	6.7	6.8	5.9	6.77
★★★★	Mahi Manu Ultra Short Duration	1446.4	212	0.7	0.3	6.2	6.8	6.9	5.9	3.55
★★★★	SBI Ultra Short Duration	6283.7	12553	0.6	0.4	6.2	6.9	7.0	6.0	8.65
★★★★	WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Dur	1426.1	580	1.0	0.5	5.7	6.3	6.4	5.6	-
★★★★	BOI Ultra Short Duration	3316.5	154	0.9	0.3	5.9	6.4	6.4	5.6	7.16
★★★★	LIC MF Ultra Short Duration	1384.4	342	1.2	0.2	5.7	6.4	6.4	5.5	1.58
★★★★	PGIM India Ultra Short Duration	35.6	167	0.9	0.4	5.6	6.3	6.4	5.6	3.01
★★★★	Tata Ultra Short Term	14.9	5713	1.2	0.3	6.0	6.6	6.6	5.6	8.37
★★★★	Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	3982.2	498	1.0	0.4	5.8	6.4	6.4	5.4	-
★★★★	Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.2	428	1.0	0.2	5.2	5.6	5.7	4.8	-
★★★★	Sundaram Ultra Short Duration	2800.8	1817	1.4	0.2	5.2	5.9	6.0	5.1	1.71

DEBT - LOW DURATION FUNDS

★★★★★	ICICI Pru Savings	573.0	27700	0.6	0.4	6.5	7.3	7.5	6.5	6.63
★★★★★	UTI Low Duration	3733.8	3108	0.4	0.3	6.3	7.2	7.2	7.3	7.09
★★★★★	Axis Treasury Advantage	3253.9	6084	0.7	0.3	6.3	7.1	7.1	6.2	7.38

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	

★★★★★	DSP Low Duration	20.8	5108	0.6	0.3	5.9	6.8	6.9	5.9	-
★★★★★	HDFC Low Duration	60.6	21926	1.1	0.5	5.9	6.8	6.9	6.0	12.68
★★★★★	HSBC Low Duration	30.1	1058	0.9	0.4	6.1	7.6	7.5	6.2	9.66
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Low Duration	686.8	13267	1.2	0.4	5.7	6.5	6.6	5.8	10.00
★★★★	Bandhan Low Duration	40.5	6121	0.7	0.4	5.9	6.9	6.9	5.9	-
★★★★	Canara Robeco Savings	44.3	1140	0.5	0.2	6.1	6.9	7.0	5.9	-
★★★★	Invesco India Low Duration	3971.9	1690	0.7	0.3	6.0	6.9	7.0	5.9	6.04
★★★★	JM Low Duration	38.9	223	0.9	0.4	5.9	6.8	6.8	5.8	5.59
★★★★	Nippon Ind Low Duration	3927.8	9417	1.1	0.4	6.0	6.9	6.9	6.0	7.52
★★★★	SBI Low Duration	3657.4	13458	0.9	0.4	5.7	6.7	6.7	5.8	3.92
★★★★	Tata Treasury Advantage	4125.6	2859	0.6	0.3	6.0	6.9	6.9	5.9	3.99
★★★★	Kotak Low Duration	3502.4	16259	1.2	0.4	5.8	6.7	6.7	5.8	11.10
★★★★	Mahi Manu Low Duration	1713.1	561	1.1	0.3	5.8	6.7	6.7	5.6	13.58
★★★★	Mirae Asset Low Duration	2367.1	2314	0.8	0.2	5.8	6.8	6.8	5.7	4.97
★★★★	Sundaram Low Duration	3615.8	369	1.2	0.4	5.5	6.6	6.6	5.7	3.53
★★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Low Duration	42.0	292	1.0	0.3	5.7	6.6	6.6	5.6	1.72
★★★★	LIC MF Low Duration	41.4	1692	0.4	0.3	5.7	6.6	6.6	5.6	3.14

FPIs’ stake in Indian equities drops to 14-yr low

LENDING SUPPORT. Domestic institutions emerge as market stabilisers with share rising to 18.9 per cent

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

Foreign portfolio investors’ (FPIs) share in Indian equities has fallen to a nearly 14-year low, even as domestic institutions have quietly emerged as the market’s largest stakeholder — a structural shift unfolding alongside another week of sustained foreign selling.

Per NSDL data, FPIs were net sellers in Indian equities in four of the five trading sessions during the week ended May 8.

On Monday (May 4), they pulled out ₹8,035.69 crore through stock exchanges. Tuesday offered brief respite, with FPIs turning net buyers worth ₹2,969.02 crore.

Selling resumed on Wed-

nesday with outflows of ₹3,399.03 crore, followed by the sell-off on Thursday at ₹5,697.61 crore.

By Friday (May 8), selling had nearly tapered off, with net outflows narrowing sharply to ₹69.31 crore, as gross purchases of ₹18,514.38 crore almost matched gross sales of ₹18,583.69 crore.

On an aggregate basis — combining stock exchange and primary market flows — FPI equity outflows for the week stood at ₹14,207.20 crore.

DIIs GAIN

The weekly trend reflects a broader structural shift. According to JM Financial’s monthly tracker for April 2026, FPI ownership in Indian equities has dropped to 14.7 per cent — the lowest



The reason India is being passed over is partly structural

since June 2012 — from 19.9 per cent a decade ago. In contrast, domestic institutional investors (DIIs) now hold 18.9 per cent of Indian equities, overtaking FPIs for the first time since December 2024 and steadily widening the gap.

VK Vijayakumar, Chief Investment Strategist at Geojit Investments Ltd, said, “This takes the total FPI sell figure through exchanges in 2026, so far, to ₹2,18,540 crore,” he said, while noting that primary market investment by FPIs has remained resilient, with “total investment of ₹12,340 crore, so far, this year.”

N ArunaGiri, CEO of TrustLine Holdings, said, “At a time when Korea received nearly \$4 billion and Taiwan around \$5.5 billion in flows, India is still not getting its due share of emerging market allocations. This clearly indicates that FIIs currently do not find India as attractive from an allocation perspective,” he said.

The impact, he added, is visible in market behaviour. “Large caps have relatively

underperformed, while strong domestic flows have continued to support the SMID segment.”

STRUCTURAL DIVERSION

Analysts said India’s underperformance in attracting foreign flows is partly structural.

“The impressive earnings growth expected in markets like South Korea and Taiwan this year, thanks to the AI boom, is attracting FPI flows into these markets in a big way,” he said.

ArunaGiri noted that “FPIs have been investing in certain sectors like power, construction and capital goods.”

He cautioned that any sustained recovery in large-caps would depend on a reversal in foreign investor sentiment.

PM to unveil ₹1,535 cr worth Telangana rail projects today

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Prime Minister Narendra Modi will inaugurate railway infrastructure projects worth ₹1,535 crore in Telangana on May 10.

Modi will dedicate to the nation key railway infrastructure projects. These include multiple sections of the Kazipet-Vijayawada multi-tracking project covering 118 km. The project will enhance line capacity on the busy Grand Trunk corridor, enabling faster train operations, reducing congestion, improving punctuality and boosting freight traffic across the region. Further, the Kazipet rail under rail bypass will also be dedicated to the nation.



April e-Way bill generation up 12% despite W. Asia concerns

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Amid apprehensions of the West Asia crisis impacting consumption demand, e-Way bill generation rose 12 per cent in April compared with the corresponding month of last fiscal, data from GST Network showed.

However, it is 5 per cent lower on month-on-month basis. Data showed total e-Way bill generation at 13.34 crore in April this year against 11.93 crore in April last year and an all-time high of 14 crore in March this year. The latest number of e-Way bill generation could have some impact on GST mop-up in May, data for which will be out on June 1. However, the actual collection depends on actual consumption as GST is destination-based. Also, services and movement of goods beyond a certain threshold are not included in e-Way bill generation.

Meanwhile, officials say the trend is normal and implies that war in West Asia has not impacted the demand much as of now. Experts are also of the same opinion.

BUSINESS ACTIVITY

Manoj Mishra, Partner at Grant Thornton Bharat, said the 12 per cent growth in e-Way bill generation for April reflects continued re-



silience in underlying economic activity, healthy movement of goods and sustained formalisation of trade and supply chains under GST. That said, the moderation compared to March figures appears largely seasonal in nature. March typically witnesses elevated business activity driven by year-end sales push, inventory adjustments, and closure-related activities by companies.

“With the beginning of the new fiscal, a sequential cooling-off in volumes is a normal trend and does not necessarily indicate a slowdown in consumption or trade momentum. Overall, the e-Way bill data continue to signal stable domestic demand and improving tax compliance trends,” he said.

MUTHOOT CAPITAL SERVICES LIMITED						
CIN: L67120KL1994PLC007726						
Regd. Office: 3 rd Floor, Muthoot Towers, M.G. Road, Kochi – 682 035, Kerala						
Tel: 0484 – 6619 600, Email: secretarial@muthootcap.com, Web: www.muthootcap.com						
Extract of the Audited Financial Results for the Quarter and Financial Year ended March 31, 2026						
Sl. No	Particulars	Quarter ended			Year ended	
		31.03.2026 (Audited)	31.12.2025 (Un-audited)	31.03.2025 (Audited)	31.03.2026 (Audited)	31.03.2025 (Audited)
1.	Total Income from Operations	16,660.50	15,507.96	13,731.83	62,056.63	47,165.31
2.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	943.85	1,031.56	698.04	1,730.24	6,039.77
3.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	775.43	1,031.56	698.04	1,561.82	6,039.77
4.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	536.54	765.06	642.16	1,117.33	4,574.40
5.	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (After tax)]	502.68	843.39	594.93	1,235.72	4,631.47
6.	Paid up Equity Share Capital	1,644.75	1,644.75	1,644.75	1,644.75	1,644.75
7.	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)	65,397.33	64,894.65	64,161.61	65,397.33	64,161.61
8.	Securities Premium Account	20,134.80	20,134.80	20,134.80	20,134.80	20,134.80
9.	Net Worth	67,042.08	66,539.40	65,806.36	67,042.08	65,806.36
10.	Outstanding Debt	3,31,383.95	3,19,997.66	2,85,323.23	3,31,383.95	2,85,323.23
11.	Outstanding Redeemable Preference Shares	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL
12.	Debt Equity Ratio	4.94	4.81	4.34	4.94	4.34
13.	Earnings Per Share (EPS) – each (for continuing and discontinued operations)					
1.	Basic (₹)*	3.26	4.65	3.90	6.79	27.81
2.	Diluted (₹)*	3.26	4.65	3.90	6.79	27.81
14.	Capital Redemption Reserve	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL
15.	Debt Redemption Reserve	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL
16.	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL
17.	Interest Service Coverage Ratio	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL

Note:

(a) The above is an extract of the detailed format of Audited Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 & 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Audited Financial Results are available on the National Stock Exchange of India website (URL: www.nseindia.com/corporates) and on the Company's website (URL: www.muthootcap.com/investors).

(b) The above-mentioned Audited Financial Results were approved by the Board of Directors of the Company, based on the recommendations of the Audit Committee, at its Meeting held on May 08, 2026. The Statutory Auditors of the Company have expressed an unmodified opinion on the aforementioned Financial Results. For the other item(s) referred in Regulation 52(4) of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, pertinent disclosures have been made to the Stock Exchanges and can be accessed on the National Stock Exchange of India website (URL: www.nseindia.com/corporates), the BSE Ltd. website (URL: www.bseindia.com/corporates).

For Muthoot Capital Services Limited
Sd/-
Tina Suzanne George
Whole Time Director
DIN: 09775050

Place: Kochi
Date : May 08, 2026

Muthoot Homefin						
Muthoot Homefin (India) Limited						
CIN: U65922KL2011PLC029231						
Statement of Standalone Audited financial results for the quarter and year ended March 31, 2026						
(Rs in Lakhs)						
Particulars	Quarter Ended		Year Ended			
	March 31, 2026	March 31, 2025	March 31, 2026	March 31, 2025		
	Audited	Audited	Audited	Audited		
1	Total income from Operations	11,536.43	9,834.96	43,278.32	32,633.14	
2	Net Profit/ (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items#)	3,421.99	1,732.55	6,656.66	5,404.67	
3	Net Profit/ (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items#)	3,421.99	1,732.55	6,656.66	5,404.67	
4	Net Profit/ (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items#)	2,611.43	1,273.39	4,544.48	3,947.83	
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	2,604.67	1,262.11	4,537.72	3,936.55	
6	Paid up Equity Share Capital	14,582.25	11,915.58	14,582.25	11,915.58	
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserves)	61,479.55	39,608.52	61,479.55	39,608.52	
8	Securities Premium Account	38,801.40	21,468.07	38,801.40	21,468.07	
9	Net Worth	76,061.80	51,524.10	76,061.80	51,524.10	
10	Paid up Debt Capital / Outstanding Debt	2,42,513.65	2,10,282.74	2,42,513.65	2,10,282.74	
11	Outstanding Redeemable Preference Shares	Nil	Nil	Nil	Nil	
12	Debt Equity Ratio	3.19	4.08	3.19	4.08	
13	Earnings per equity share (Face Value of Rs. 10/- Each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)					
	Basic (Rs.)	1.95	1.07	3.39	3.31	
	Diluted (Rs.)	1.95	1.07	3.39	3.31	
14	Capital Redemption Reserve	NA	NA	NA	NA	
15	Debt Redemption Reserve	NA	NA	NA	NA	
16	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	NA	NA	NA	NA	
17	Interest Service Coverage Ratio	NA	NA	NA	NA	
# - Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items adjusted in the Statement of Profit and Loss in accordance with Ind AS Rules/ AS Rules, whichever is applicable.						

Note:

a) The above is an extract of the detailed format of Audited Financial Results for the quarter and year ended March 31, 2026 filed with Stock Exchange under Regulation 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Audited Financial Results are available on the website of BSE Limited (www.bseindia.com) where the Securities of the Company are listed and is available on the website of the Company at www.muthoothomefin.com.

b) For the other line items referred in Regulation 52(4) of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, the pertinent disclosures are made to BSE Limited and is accessible on www.bseindia.com

c) The above financial results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and subsequently approved by the Board of Directors in their respective meetings held on May 04, 2026 and May 08, 2026.

d) These financial results have been prepared in accordance with Regulation 52 of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, as amended.



Place: Kochi
Date: 08.05.2026

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors

Eapen Alexander
Whole time Director
DIN 03493601

Medi Assist Healthcare Services Limited						
CIN: L74900MH2000PLC437885						
Registered Office: AARPEE Chambers, SSRP Building, 7 th Floor, Andheri Kurla Road, Marol						
Co-operative Industrial Estate Road, Gamdevi, Marol, Andheri East, Marol Bazar, Mumbai - 400 059.						
Phone: +91 - 22 - 6259 6797 Email: investor.relations@mediassist.in Website: www.mediassist.in						
STATEMENT OF AUDITED CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND YEAR ENDED MARCH 31, 2026						
(₹ In millions unless otherwise stated)						
Sr. No.	Particulars	Quarter Ended			Year Ended	
		March 31, 2026	December 31, 2025	March 31, 2025	March 31, 2026	March 31, 2025
		(Audited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)
1	Total Income from Operations	2,419.86	2,396.78	1,888.72	9,047.67	7,233.21
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	279.04	226.63	300.47	945.47	1,117.87
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	279.04	84.68	300.47	803.52	1,117.87
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax from continuing operations (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	544.77	41.36	216.33	893.11	916.01
5	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax from continuing operations and discontinued operations (after Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	544.77	41.36	215.88	893.11	915.18
6	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	520.85	66.29	196.83	919.84	892.84
7	Paid up Equity Share Capital (Face value of ₹ 5/- each)	373.05	372.29	352.61	373.05	352.61
8	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of the previous year				8,015.98	5,062.09
9	Earnings Per Share (EPS) (of ₹ 5/- each) (from continuing and discontinued operations)*					
	1. Basic	7.33	0.51	3.05	12.14	12.91
	2. Diluted	7.33	0.51	3.04	12.14	12.85

Notes:

Standalone Financial Results for the Quarter and Year ended March 31, 2026

Sr. No.	Particulars	Quarter Ended			Year Ended	
		March 31, 2026	December 31, 2025	March 31, 2025	March 31, 2026	March 31, 2025
		(Audited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)
1	Revenue from contracts with customers	635.63	574.28	425.53	2,254.55	1,505.86
2	Profit/ (Loss) before tax (before exceptional items)	193.99	157.51	147.90	688.18	445.54
3	Profit/ (Loss) before tax (after exceptional items)	193.99	156.99	147.90	687.66	445.54
4	Profit/ (Loss) after tax from continuing operations	144.97	118.33	107.31	519.86	332.08
5	Profit/ (Loss) after tax from continuing operations and discontinued operations	144.97	118.33	107.31	519.86	332.08

1. The above audited consolidated financial results of Medi Assist Healthcare Services Limited ("the Holding Company" or "the Company"), its subsidiaries have been reviewed and recommended by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors, at their respective meetings held on May 09, 2026. These audited consolidated financial results have been audited by the statutory auditors of the Company and they have issued an unmodified report on these audited consolidated financial results.

2. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarter and year ended Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of Financial Results are available on the websites of the Stock Exchange(s) i.e., www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com and the Company at www.mediassist.in/investor-relations/. The same can be accessed by scanning the QR code provided below.

3. The Board of Directors at their meeting held on May 09, 2026 have recommended a final dividend of ₹ 2/- per equity share of ₹ 5/- each for the financial year ended March 31, 2026. The said proposed dividend is subject to approval from the shareholders of the Company at the ensuing annual general meeting and are not recognised as a liability as on March 31, 2026.

4. During the quarter ended March 31, 2026, the paid-up equity share capital of the Company has increased from ₹ 352.61 millions to ₹ 373.05 millions, pursuant to exercise of stock options by certain employees and allotment of 385,863 equity shares and 3,701,000 equity shares by way of preferential allotment of shares thereon.



Place : Mumbai
Date : May 09, 2026

For MEDI ASSIST HEALTHCARE SERVICES LIMITED
Sd/-
Satish V N Gidugu
CEO & Whole-Time Director